ANNUAL
MUSEUM OF VICTORIA
REPORT
1987 - 1988

Penny Morison

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CONTENTS

REPORT OF THE COUNCIL 1987-88 5

REPORT ON ACTIVITIES FOR 1987-88 9

NATURAL HISTORY DIVISION

Geology 11

Department of Mineralogy and Petrology
Department of Invertebrate Palaeontology
Department of Vertebrate Palaeontology and Palaeobotany

Invertebrate Zoology 14

Department of Invertebrate Zoology
Department of Crustacea
Department of Entomology
Environmental Records

Vertebrate Zoology 18

Department of Ichthyology
Department of Herpetology
Department of Ornithology
Department of Mammalogy
Grants to Natural History Department

SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY DIVISION 22

Department of Arms
Department of Astronomy
Department of Communications, Electronics and Medicine
Department of Engineering and Transport
Department of Numismatics
Department of Photography and Cinematography
Department of Rural Science

PUBLIC PROGRAMMES DIVISION 26

Museum Resource Service

Education Service Section
Community Service Section

CONTENTS

Public Relations
Childrens Museum
Commercial Operations
Museum Resource Service
Construction Workshop
Technical Workshop
Photography Section
Preparators
Design Section

HUMAN STUDIES DIVISION 33

Aboriginal Studies
Victorian Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Unit
Victorian Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Trust
History
Oceanic Studies
The Science and Humanities Committee Management of the Museum of Victorian Council

MANAGEMENT SERVICES DIVISION 37

General

Building and Property
Finance
Personal and Office Services
Stores and Transport
Library
Safety/Security and Cleaning Services
Occupational, Health and Safety Committee
— Safety Committee

The Building Management Committee 38

APPENDIXES

1. Council of the Museum of Victoria 42
2. Museum Staff 42
3. Honorary Positions and Volunteers 46
4. Publications by Museum Staff 47
5. Auditor's Report and Financial Statements 50 51

Report of the Council 1987/1988

To The Honourable the Minister for the Arts

Sir,

The Museum of Victoria Council presents herewith its Annual Report for the year ending 30th June, 1988, in accordance with Section 30 of the Museums Act 1983.

During the year Council held 9 meetings. Office bearers were:

President - Professor J.W. Warren
Deputy President - Mr P. Parkin
Treasurer - Mr I. Sinclair

Three members of Council retired, Ms J. Lennon, Dr N. Wettenhall and Professor F. Jevons, to be replaced by Ms M. Cameron, Mr J. Ellis and Mr G. Woodard. Council was pleased to invite Dr Wettenhall to become a Fellow of the Museum in recognition of his long and continuing service. Similar awards were made to Professor D. J. Mulvaney, a distinguished Australian anthropologist and associate of the Museum, and to DR. A.G. Serle, a previous Council member who continues to contribute to the activities of the Division of Human Studies.

Council wishes to congratulate Mr John Kendall, previously Director of the Science Museum of Victoria and pro tem Director of the Museum of Victoria, on receiving a well deserved Order of Australia.

In the course of the year The Hon. Race Mathews M.P. was succeeded as Minister for the Arts by the Hon. Ian Cathie, M.P. Council wishes to record its gratitude to Mr Mathews for his strong support and the role he played in museum developments over the years. As the incoming Minister, Council thanks you for the immediate interest you took in our affairs. We welcomed your presence at our February meeting and noted your announcement with respect to redevelopment of the Museum, i.e. the State Library would assume all the site currently occupied by the Library and Museum with the Museum transferring to new premises adjacent and at Spotswood. In line with this, Council continued formal negotiations with the Melbourne and Metropolitan Board of Works to establish a Science and Technology facility at the former M.M.B.W. Pumping Station at Spotswood.

The Government's proposal for redevelopment of the Library and Museum, and the establishment of a Project Control Group to oversee this, caused the State Library/Museum Buildings Advisory Committee to consider its future as an advisory body to Government. As a result, and

following the resignation of the Chairman, it was your decision to terminate the Committee. The new, proposed structure to form a construction company with the Project Control Group overseeing Government responsibility, has the full support of Council.

The public profile of the Museum has benefited greatly by the exhibitions programme outlined in the report of the Division of Public Programmes. In conjunction with the International Cultural Corporation of Australia the Museum hosted several outstanding touring exhibitions. One of these, 'First Impressions', allowed visitors to see, inter alia, a selection of paintings made by those Europeans who first made contact with the Australian continent. The exhibition was prepared by the British Museum of Natural History in association with the Museum of Victoria. It was opened by Her Majesty the Queen of Australia.

A further twenty new exhibitions were mounted, in addition to maintaining and enhancing the longstanding, permanent ones. Two of these deserve special attention. One, 'Salinity' because of its educational value in alerting Victorians to a serious problem of soil degradation, and because it is touring 13 regional centres. And two, the joint exhibition with the Victorian Aboriginal Heritage Trust because together we are planning to develop this display into a major Aboriginal exhibition entitled 'Koorie' to be opened late in 1988. These exhibitions, as well as others cited within this Report, have been generously supported by public and corporate sponsors.

Exhibitions and public programmes are only one aspect of the activities of major museums; maintaining the collections on which changing exhibitions rely and which form the basis for scientific and historical studies, is equally important, if not more important. Victoria has a poor record for providing conservation facilities necessary to care for the Museum's priceless collections. The deteriorating state of many irreplaceable items has been called to the Government's and public's attention and action is being considered to rectify the situation. The condition of the collections is mentioned further in this report, including references to valuable items offered to the State but not accepted due to inadequate facilities.

Nevertheless, moderate acquisitions which significantly enhance existing collections have been obtained as reported herein, and one substantial private collection has been placed here on long term loan. The latter is a selection of tribal art from Africa and Papua New Guinea owned by the Christensen Fund, a charitable trust in the U.S.A. We are very appreciative of this gesture as will be the people of Victoria when items from this collection are placed on display.

The importance of the collections for research is summarised in the reports of individual Divisions. The results of this research find their way into different Government reports, specialist international journals, and the Memoirs of the Museum of Victoria, of which volumes 48 and 49 were published this year. With respect to major projects attention is called to one of these, the Photographic Archive Project within the Division of Science and Technology. This project, conceived and initiated by staff of this Museum, has proven so valuable and popular it is now being duplicated in other states.

Education continues as a major thrust. Over 200,000 school children made use of the Museum Education Service. Of special note was the Department of Rural Science's participation in a Summer School at Day's Mill and Farm, Murchison, and the particularly successful Outreach Project

servicing centres away from the Museum proper. Also the Planetarium continues as popular as ever receiving over 80,000 visitors this year, half being school groups. The planetarium projector is reaching the end of its useful life and Council has established a sinking replacement fund to renew this facility in due course.

The Museum depends heavily on private and corporate support for its many programmes and we acknowledge with thanks the indebtedness to our many generous benefactors who are cited in the body of the Report. Also we extend our thanks to you and your predecessor, as Minister for the Arts, for your continuing support.

J.W. Warren
President

REPORT ON ACTIVITIES FOR 1987-88

DIVISION OF NATURAL HISTORY

THE DIVISION is responsible for the care and maintenance of the zoological and geological collections of the Museum. The staff carries out research relevant to these collections and provides an identification and information service for the general public, scientists and Government Departments, as well as for the exhibition and educational activities of the Museum.

The Division maintained initiatives to achieve organisation and management of collections to ensure that the priceless items of Natural History and the science they represent are more readily available to the people of Victoria.

Restructuring of the Division proceeded with the appointment of Dr Les Christidis as Curator of Ornithology. This post has been vacant since the retirement of Mr Allan McEvey in 1984.

Funding of Divisional activities continues to be supplemented substantially by outside grants. Almost $100,000 was generated from this source by staff of the Division. This strategy for the relief of the inevitable strain of vote funded projects continues to be explored with vigour.

Evaluation of future priorities places continued emphasis on both better management of collections and communication of information about those collections to the public of Victoria. In this latter context, the Division is focusing on environmental understanding, on aspects of habitat and on the history of items in the collections. Towards this end, the Division mounted a major exhibition on the problems of salinity. Entitled **Salt and the Earth**, the exhibition funded by the State Salinity Bureau is currently touring thirteen regional centres of the State. With its instructor, Mr Roger Jones, the exhibition has already provided opportunities for systematic instruction of more than 10,000 school children about this critical environmental problem. A special video produced by the Museum, **The Weeping Earth**, is available to assist in public education of the salinity problem.

A new programme in Environmental Education is being advanced through a series of systematic studies of Victoria, region by region. The first of these focuses on the Mallee. It will commence in September 1988.

Museum Scientific Publications

Dr G.C.B. Poore continues to edit the Museum's journals, the **Memoirs of the Museum of Victoria** and **Occasional Papers from the Museum of Victoria**.

In 1987 **Memoir** volume 48, Numbers 1 and 2 (totalling 194 pages) was published. The first issue presented twenty-one short papers on the taxonomy of Australian fishes contributed by Australian and overseas authors. The second issue contained seven papers on insects, crustacea, water mites, spiders and fossil brachiopods. **Memoirs** Volume 49 Number 1 (193 pages) appeared in May 1988 with eleven papers on a range of subjects. The third **Occasional Papers** (November 1987) reported on Bass Strait sampling stations, cephalopods, and crustacean types.

Deputy Director's Section

The Museum has commenced a scheme to provide modest funds to assist research towards higher degrees, especially at the honours year level. Grants are designed to assist in work especially relevant to the collections and research in the Museum.

Three awards made in the current year went to students at the Australian National University (prehistory), the University of Melbourne (geology), and Monash University (history). Students receiving grants must agree to lodge a copy of their thesis in the Museum Library.

The design and implementation of the museum computer strategy and other aspects of Information Technology is overseen by an Information Technology Management Committee. The committee is chaired by the Deputy Director (Natural History) and includes representatives from the Department of Management and Budget and the Ministry for the Arts.

Following a report by P.A. Consultants on Museum computer needs, a recommendation for a 2-stage strategy has been adopted. Funding is being provided for stage 1 to establish two staff positions (one at the level of systems design, the other to provide technical support); to install a pilot project in the Division of Science and Technology; and to purchase 8 PCs for distribution throughout the Museum.

Stage 2, to be designed by the systems specialist in consultation with Museum staff, will involve a complete EDP strategy for the entire Museum. Already all secretarial services have been provided with word processors, resulting in a substantial improvement in service delivery.

Sunrise School

In connection with the new developments in information technology, an initiative has been undertaken in collaboration with the Australian Council of Educational Research (ACER).

In these times of huge and rapid changes in technology, the significance and adaptation of those changes is only slowly recognised by educational institutions and implementation lags far behind the development of the technology itself.

The implications of such changes are felt at two levels of particular relevance to the Museum.

First, we must identify strategies to make collection data relevant and available to the widest possible audience. With the availability of modem links, laser disk and other techniques, it will soon be feasible to provide information services based on the collections to schools, universities and public institutions throughout the State.

Secondly, the impact of such technology at the level of school instruction goes to the heart of the challenge facing educators in modern teaching institutions.

In response to these needs, an approach to the Museum from ACER for a joint venture operation has resulted in the establishment of an experimental enterprise. Under the directorship of Ms Liddy Neville of ACER, a school operation has been set up in the Museum where selected students, under teacher guidance, undertake special computer-assisted projects. Named the **Sunrise School**, the initiative aims to put students in close touch with museum objects and to introduce students to aspects of the Museum's data base, thereby providing an opportunity for a special learning environment within the context of the vast store of Museum information.

The Sunrise School was formally opened by the Minister for Industry, Technology and Resources, Senator John Button.

Salinity

Dr Bowler, assisted by Mr Peter Johnstone, undertook responsibility for organising design and construction of the Salinity Exhibition. Now mid-way through its schedule of visiting thirteen regional centres, funding has been sought to keep the exhibition in Victoria for an additional six months into 1989. Requests have been received to bring it to New South Wales and South Australia at the completion of the Victorian tour.

International Responsibilities

A. China

In collaboration with the Chinese Academy of Science, (Academia Sinica), Dr Bowler continues to advise the provincial authorities in Qinghai Province on several matters affecting environmental management of natural resources.

A meeting organised by Dr Bowler in China in 1987 identified the cause of falling levels in Qinghai Lake, a major heritage feature, as due to variations in climate. The actual nature of the climate change involved remains to be identified. In a report to the Governor of Qinghai Province, Dr Bowler proposed a systematic computer modelling study of the lake as the first essential stage in developing a long-term protection programme.

Closer to home, lakes in Western Victoria near Camperdown and Terang, have been similarly falling for the past 100

years. The environmental implications of the hydrologic changes that brought about these events both in Australia and China are of special importance in a world now threatened by increasing temperatures resulting from the Greenhouse Effect. To address these questions, research funding proposals for detailed computer modelling of lakes and catchments have been formulated in collaboration with Professor Tom McMahon, Department of Agricultural Engineering, University of Melbourne.

B. International Association for Quaternary Research (INQUA)

In August 1987 Dr Bowler attended the international congress on INQUA in Ottawa to present two papers on research in Australia and China. At the international assembly he was elected one of five international vice-presidents, the first time an Australian has been acknowledged on the INQUA executive committee.

Since joining the Museum from the Australian National University, Dr Bowler has continued his involvement in the study of Australian landscape evolution, especially in areas relating to hydrological change. In that context, collaborative links with the ANU have permitted continuation of analyses of data collected on the SLEADS Project (Salt Lake, Evaporites, Aeolian Deposits), the project for which Dr Bowler was largely responsible before joining the Museum.

GEOLOGY

The three departments in this section are responsible for the State collections of rock, minerals and fossils, which provide a record of the nature and composition of the earth over its entire history, with particular emphasis on Victoria.

DEPARTMENT OF MINERALOGY AND PETROLOGY

Research has centred on the identification and description of a suite of rare minerals from the Broken Hill ore body, and of several new species, two of which are from Victoria. The Broken Hill specimens are being provided by Minerals, Mining and Metallurgy Ltd. from their operations in the Kintore opencut. To date at least twenty species previously unrecorded from Broken Hill have been identified.

China Initiatives

The Division has initiated systematic exchanges with colleagues in China through two special contacts. The first involves a joint three year exchange agreement with the Shanghai Museum of Natural History. A visit to China by Dr Bowler and Dr Lu set the basis for this agreement, which was formally initiated during a visit to the Museum of Victoria by Deputy Director Zhang Song Ling of Shanghai. Director Zhang was accompanied by the first exchange scholar, Miss Peng Li Quing, an education officer from the Shanghai Museum.

A second contact with China arises from Dr Bowler's responsibilities advising the Governor of Qinghai Province on matters of environmental management, especially as they affect changing lake levels and increasing salinisation of Qinghai Lake. While in Qinghai, Dr Bowler and Dr Lu negotiated with provincial officials to structure a major exhibition featuring the land and the people of Qinghai-a fascinating region at the junction of Tibet and Mongolia. A memorandum of understanding was formally signed to enable planning of this exhibition to go ahead in China. Planned for 1990, it would be the first systematic exhibit of its kind from this part of central Asia.

Links between China and the Museum of Victoria were further consolidated when Dr Yen (Environmental Records) visited Guanzhou and Hainan Island to assist in the study of eucalypt ecology. Dr Yen was able to provide detailed advice on the management of eucalypt stands in this area of southern China where reafforestation using Australian flora remains priority.

Building on the Museum's affiliation agreements, staff of the Division retain close contact with colleagues in universities and scientific institutions. Staff involvement in supervision of graduate students continues, and will almost certainly expand. Currently ten students proceeding to higher degrees in universities are being supervised (or co-supervised) by staff of the Natural History Division. Staff continue to provide special lecture courses by request in universities and tertiary colleges as well as to the public and special interest groups.

Additionally, liaison with scientific staff in other public organisations, (Department of Forests, Conservation and Lands; CSIRO; Institute of Marine Sciences and many others) continues to provide day-to-day links with work within the Division. Future developments will see consolidation and expansion of these links, both at levels of academic and educational involvement and in the development of environmental management strategies.

In the past six months the Curator has been involved in the description of five new mineral

species. These are: perroudite (a complex mercury, silver sulphide-halide) from Broken Hill; sieleckiite (a copper aluminium phosphate) from Mt. Oxide, Qld; cobaltaustinite (a cobalt copper arsenate) from Dome Rock, SA; and two new Victorian species; a magnesium aluminium phosphate from a lava cave near Bacchus Marsh, and a copper calcium uranium phosphate from near Lake Boga in north-western Victoria. Papers have been published, or are in preparation, on all these occurrences.

A descriptive summary of Victorian mineralogy has been written for the new edition of **Geology of Victoria**. A chapter on the minerals of Phillip Island, will appear in the new book **Excursion Guide to Victorian Geological Sites** being published by the Australian Academy of Science.

Articles on mineral localities of interest to collectors have been published in **Australian Mineralogist**. A total of eleven scientific and general papers were published during the year.

Limited field work involved several days in a number of areas, including the Dookie area (where unusual rocks contain danburite - the first record in Victoria); Lake Boga (where a new mineral species has been found in a granite quarry) and Ballarat area locating volcanic minerals. Dermot Henry visited several mines in the ACT and at the Woodlawn mine, NSW, and collected specimens of greenockite, a rare cadmium sulphide.

Curatorial Projects

Since last July when the rock, mineral and ore collections of the Geological Survey of Victoria were transferred to the Museum of Victoria, Mineralogy staff have been endeavouring to commence cleaning, sorting and registering a collection as large and historically significant as our existing collections. As most of the GSV collection is stored in a Brooklyn warehouse and in cabinets on McCoy balcony, curating is a difficult task.

The first priority with the GSV material has been to select out any gold-bearing specimens from Victorian mines. A full listing of all the gold nugget replicas acquired in the transfer is being completed. Both tasks are being carried out largely by volunteers.

A preliminary assessment of the size and state of the geological collections held by the Geology Department of the University of Melbourne has been made pending the transfer of these collections to the Museum.

When all these rock, mineral and ore collections, consisting mainly of Victorian material, have been amalgamated, the Museum will have a unique resource for reference and research. The existing staff cannot quickly organise all new additions; it will be at least 10-15 years before the collections will be fully 'useful'.

Progress continues to be made on the task of placing all the information in the Museum's rock and mineral collection onto the computer data base. Some 24,000 records, out of 51,122 registrations, have now been entered.

Dermot Henry administers a programme wherein the meteorite collection is augmented through exchanges with collectors and dealers in Europe and the U.S.A. The collection continues to expand and is fully registered and computerised.

Loans

Eighteen institutions were loaned mineral specimens or were provided with specimens for destructive tests. Three overseas loans were made, to Dr C. Francis of Harvard University; Dr L. Bernstein of Stanford University, and to the Hiruzen Research Institute, Okayama University, Japan. In addition, twenty-two individuals or companies borrowed mineral and rock specimens for exhibitions and ten companies borrowed photographic slides and transparencies.

Acquisitions

Acquisitions for the year consisted of 610 minerals, 64 rocks and 9 meteorites, totalling 683 registrations. Significant purchases included a superb display grade specimen of green apophyllite from India, and a suite of minerals from mines in the Cue River region of Tasmania.

DEPARTMENT OF INVERTEBRATE PALAEONTOLOGY

Research Projects

Dr Darragh edited a series of letters written in Melbourne between 1862 and 1864 by Charles Sturtevant Wood and sent to James Hector in Dunedin, New Zealand. Wood was employed by the Geological Survey of Victoria as Analyst in the joint National Museum and Geological Survey of Victoria analytical laboratory. As an adjunct to the letters a short history of the setting up of the laboratory was compiled. The work has been submitted to the **Historical Records of Australian Science**.

Dr Darragh's work on the late Cretaceous bivalves from the Miria Formation, undertaken in collaboration with Mr G.W. Kendrick of the Western Australian Museum, is now in the final stages of completion. The fauna consists of 30 taxa, some of which are so poorly preserved that precise identification is impossible. One genus and five species are newly described. The fauna shows little affinity with any other late Cretaceous fauna, reflecting the isolation of the Australian plate during the late Cretaceous.

In collaboration with Dr Lars Ramskild of the Swedish National Museum of Natural History, Dr Holloway continued work on an Early Silurian trilobite fauna from limestones in the Orange district of New South Wales. The fauna is very well preserved and consists of almost forty species, several belonging to genera not previously recorded in Australia. Work commenced on a revision of the trilobite family Pterygometopidae, to appear in the **Treatise on Invertebrate Palaeontology**, a reference work published by the Geological Society of America and the University of Kansas. Progress of the work has been considerably delayed by difficulties in obtaining casts or photographs of type and figured material housed in the Soviet Union. A revision of the trilobite order Lichida by Dr Holloway, in collaboration with Dr A.T. Thomas of Aston University, UK has been accepted for publication by the Royal Society of London.

Curatorial Projects

A major part of the Department's curatorial programme during the year has been directed towards the establishment of computerised databases for specimens and fossil localities. Entry of data commenced in August; 4, 454 records have been entered in the specimen database and 529 records in the locality database.

With the assistance of volunteers, sorting, labelling and reboxing of the very large collections of Carboniferous and Permian invertebrates from Australia and overseas donated by Dr G.A. Thomas in 1987 was largely completed during the year. Work continued on the reorganisation of the foreign ammonites (cephalopods) and to date approximately three-quarters of the collection has been relabelled and arranged into families, and the records entered on the computer database.

Reorganisation of the foreign Bryozoa and computerisation of the foreign trilobites were both commenced during the year. Little progress has been made on the bryozoans, however, owing to the taxonomic difficulties presented by the group.

There were 613 new registrations of specimens during the year.

Loans

A total of sixteen loans involving more than 1,000 specimens were made during the year to three Australian and eight overseas institutions, the latter being in West Germany, Belgium, Great Britain, New Zealand, Canada and the United States.

A computerised loans database has been established and all loans from January of this year were processed using this facility.

Acquisitions

During recreation leave in South Australia, Dr Darragh visited Kangaroo Island and collected a suite of Pliocene molluscs from the Point Ellen Formation, and Eocene echinoids from the Kingscote Limestone. Molluscs were collected from the Late Eocene Blanch Point Marl, south of Adelaide.

Staff

On 1 May Ms P. Clark, Technical Assistant in the Department, commenced twelve months maternity leave, recreation leave and leave without pay on,. The Department's Technical Officer position was not able to be filled, but Mrs June Van Zyl Viljoen was temporarily appointed as Technical Assistant in the position from May last year.

Mrs L. Haupt was appointed as temporary Technical Assistant for 5 weeks during October and November to replace Ms Clark, who was attending a Public Service Board Bridging Course.

Visitors

Professor G.K.B. Alberti of the University of Hamburg spent two and a half months in the Department from March, under the Museum Council's Visiting Scientists Programme. Professor Alberti is a world authority on tentaculites, an extinct group of conical or tusk-like shells often regarded as having affinities with molluscs. In addition to studying specimens already in the collections, Professor Alberti (mostly accompanied by Drs Darragh and Holloway) made several trips to collect additional material from Lower Devonian sequences at Buchan, Tyers, the Marysville-Matlock district and Mansfield. A detailed zonation of these fossils has been developed in the Lower and Middle Devonian of Europe. Professor Alberti's work will lead to improvements in the correlation of the Lower Devonian sequences of Victoria.

DEPARTMENT OF VERTEBRATE PALAEONTOLOGY AND PALAEOBOTANY

Research Projects

The investigation of the ancestry of modern Australian mammals and the study of Australian dinosaur faunas continued to be the focus of this Department's research programme.

Five papers have been submitted for publication.

To complete analysis of the dinosaur and other tetrapod collections from Dinosaur Cove made during the summers of 1984-7, the Curator visited a number of museums in Britain and North America. From this, the presence of two dinosaur families previously unrecognised in Australia was identified. In addition, the best known dinosaur in the collection appears to have had an unusually large region of its brain devoted to processing visual signals, perhaps an adaptation to coping with the prolonged periods of darkness each winter because the creature lived then within the Antarctic Circle.

While on this trip, the Curator attended a conference on the 'Origin of the Antarctic Biota' sponsored jointly by the British Antarctic Survey and the Geological Society of London. As Australia and Antarctica were joined together when the Victorian dinosaurs lived and died, the conference was a most fruitful source of information on this topic.

Work continued on the investigation of collagen content in fossil vertebrate bone. Collagen from one fossil site, although fifteen million years old, is so well preserved that it may be technically possible to work out the structure of this protein by sequencing the amino acids. If the work currently underway is successful, it will provide analogous information for fossils, something never before available.

Curatorial Projects

The major curatorial program involved entry of data about registered specimens into computer files. Work experience students from the Royal Melbourne Institute of Technology assisted with data input. In addition, registration of specimens was carried out by RMIT volunteers and Mr Ernest Bannister. About 600 specimens were registered during the year. Other volunteers updated a file giving the physical location of the registered specimens in the collection. A major curating effort is being undertaken by Mrs Mary-Lee MacDonald and visiting Honorary Associate Dr J. Ried MacDonald, retired Curator of Palaeontology of the Los Angeles County Museum of Natural History. Mr Colin Mcrae has completed compilation of sixty per cent of the fossil localities represented by one or more specimens in the collection.

Loans

241 specimens were loaned to ten institutions within Australia. Eleven specimens were loaned to four institutions overseas.

INVERTEBRATE ZOOLOGY

The four Departments in the section are responsible for the State collections of insects, spiders, ticks and mites, crustaceans and all other invertebrate animals from marine and terrestrial environments and for invertebrate biological survey and ecological research.

DEPARTMENT OF INVERTEBRATE ZOOLOGY

Research Projects

In December 1987 the Curator accompanied Dr J. Bowler to visit Shanghai and Xining, China, for discussion with the officials of the Shanghai Museum of Natural History in regard to the affiliation programme between the Shanghai Museum of Natural History and the Museum of Victoria. While in Shanghai, the Curator also visited the East China Sea Fisheries Research Institute for discussion with the officials there regarding the Cephalopod International Advisory Council (CIAC) sponsored training course on cephalopod fisheries biology research which the Curator is co-ordinating on behalf of CIAC.

After the visit to the MNHNP the Curator attended the Executive Council meeting of the Cephalopod International Advisory Council in Washington DC, and the CIAC International Workshop on Cephalopod Systematics and Biogeography. In addition to the working papers mentioned above, he also gave a talk on cuttlefish biogeography.

The Assistant Curator continued the compilation of a checklist of Southern Australian marine bivalves. Approximately half of the sixty families (including over 1,000 nominal species) are now in final draft.

Curatorial Projects

Routine curation and conservation task were assisted by enthusiastic volunteers.

Main programmes undertaken during the year were:

- continuing the upgrading of the curation of the opisthobranch (mollusc) collection.

- upgrading of the curation of the cephalopod collection
- relocation of coral material to make room for fast expanding and frequently used mollusc material.

Loans

Twenty loans were made to Australian institutions and fifteen to overseas institutions, totallying 366 lots.

Acquisitions

Twenty-two major accessions comprising in excess of 4,000 specimens of invertebrates were processed. The major accessions were:

- a large collection of echinoderms from Southern Australia;
- a large collection of molluscs from Lizard Island and the slope waters off the Great Barrier Reef;
- a large collection of various invertebrates, mostly molluscs from localities in SA and WA.

DEPARTMENT OF CRUSTACEA

Research Projects

The collection offers innumerable opportunities for taxonomic research and is built up largely as part of research programmes. Research is supported almost entirely by grants from federal agencies.

In January the Curator and the Assistant Curator attended the Australian Marine Sciences Association's International Workshop on Marine Biology in Albany, Western Australia, and made an extensive collection of marine invertebrates in different localities in South Australia and Western Australia. The collection, comprising some 500 lots (mainly molluscs), represents a significant addition to the Museum's collection in which very few specimens from those localities had been represented. A collection of blue ringed octopus *Hapalochlaera maculosa* was made in the Albany area, the western limit of the distribution of this species, and will serve to clarify some of the taxonomic confusion of this complex.

In May, 1988 the Curator visited the Museum National d'Histoire Naturelle, Paris (MNHMP) for eight weeks. The trip was to carry out two major projects:

- To prepare a catalogue of extant cephalopod types of the Museum. The cephalopod collection of the Paris Museum is a very important collection both historically and scientifically. The collection dates back to Lamarck and also contains numerous types of de Blainville, Ferussac and d'Orbigny. Unfortunately, lack of staff interest and expertise in cephalopods over the past seven decades has resulted in poor curation and documentation of this material. As the result of the work of the Curator, a catalogue in manuscript form has been completed jointly with Dr R. Boucher-Rodoni of the MNHNP.

It will be submitted to the **Bulletin** of MNHNP for consideration for publication. The catalogue manuscript has already proved its usefulness during the Cephalopod International Advisory Council International Workshop on cephalopod systematics and biogeography conducted in the Smithsonian Institution in July 1988.

- To identify and study the newly acquired material of MNHNP. Over 400 lots of cephalopod material from the eastern Atlantic and the Western South Pacific were studied. Among this material those from New Caledonia, Indonesia, and the Philippines have been borrowed for detailed studies as they are relevant to the studies of Australian fauna. Additionally, the Curator was offered access to a large collection of pelagic cephalopods (over 300 lots) from the Coral Sea. The material has been sent to the Museum of Victoria for collection as reference material. This collection will be very important in the study of the Australian cephalopod fauna.

While at the MNHNP, the Curator completed two other papers entitled 'Australian Sepiidae' and 'Cuttlebone as a systematic character'. These papers were used as working papers at the CIAC Workshop in Washington in July. After the normal referee process, they will appear in the Workshop handbook, which will be published as a **Smithsonian Contribution to Zoology** Volume 1.

Funds from the Australian Biological Resources Study have provided a salary for Ms Helen Lew Ton for some years and will do so until August 1988. Papers continue to be published on the systematics of marine Isopoda and have several projects in various stages of preparation. More and more, this research is moving from descriptions of the numerous unnamed Australian species towards exploration of higher taxa and the peculiarities of the Australian fauna. For example, two new families have recently been added to what has, until now, been a fairly stable classification.

ABRS funds research on an Australia-wide basis. This has recently enabled field trips to be made to Lizard Island on the Great Barrier Reef, and to Tasmania. Valuable comparative material on Isopoda and other groups was added to the collection on each occasion.

Achievements in research on crustacean taxa other than Isopoda include:

- compilation of a joint study with J.K. Lowry at the Australian Museum on ingolfiellidean amphipods based on material from Bass Strait;
- identifications and descriptions of an unusual new order of crustacean from the eastern continental slope;
- a section of the **Zoological Catalogue of Australia** for the Bureau of Flora and Fauna;
- continued work on wood-boring marine isopods under Mr Laurie Cookson, a PhD student supervised by Dr Poore;
- Tutorial sessions on identification of marine crustaceans and polychaetes conducted for students from Western Australia and Queensland.

Curatorial Projects

Servicing the collection improved following the appointment of a departmental technical officer. Much of his time has been taken up with refining and updating the TITAN-based register system for the collection and in reorganising material on the shelves to make it more accessible. Like many other marine invertebrate groups, Australian crustaceans are poorly known and most of the collection cannot be identified; it is therefore extremely difficult to sort. Specimens can only be shelved uncatalogued and await attention from expert taxonomists. To overcome the problem of insufficient manpower, time and expertise to register the entire collection, priorities have to be set. Only type material, material on loan, specimens used in taxonomic research and material easily identifiable to species is registered.

Growth in the collection over the last ten years has been considerable and it is now beginning to become more representative of the fauna. Curatorial activities over the last year have resulted in publication of two papers. The first is a catalogue of types of freshwater yabbies and the second is a listing of sampling stations and description of the Bass Strait Survey.

The SEAS Programme

The SEAS (south-eastern Australian slope) programme is a joint study between three Museum Departments (Crustacea, Invertebrate Zoology and Ichthyology) and the Victorian Institute of Marine Sciences (VIMS). It is funded by federal money through the Marine Sciences and Technologies Scheme. The programme is a major marine research initiative of the Museum and follows on from the Bass Strait Survey, which concentrated on shallower shelf depths. Dr Jean Just, an employee of VIMS and a Research Associate, works on the programme. During 1987 he processed all the material collected during a cruise of the CSIRO research vessel **Franklin** and discovered unprecedented faunal diversity for a slope community. In 1988 Dr Just has become more involved in identification and description of parts of the crustacean fauna and has closely documented this diversity.

In June Dr Just attended an international deep-sea conference in France and, on behalf of all SEAS participants, presented a paper and poster on the scope and preliminary results of the project. We hope this will engender interest in previously unknown Australian fauna. Dr Just's results show that our rather meagre sampling in 1986 has turned up more families of isopod crustaceans than have been found in any comparable area in the world. Already the Museum Collections of deep sea material are the equal of those in any museum.

Loans

The Bass Strait Survey, the SEAS programme, and other field work has provided plenty of material for taxonomic study by carcinologists around the world. In the last year fourteen loans, mostly large lots of unidentified material, have been made to workers in Australia, New Zealand, the UK, Ireland and Denmark. Some have returned promptly but others are so diverse as to require years of study.

Acquisitions

The most important new acquisitions are from field work on the Great Barrier Reef and Tasmania. Material from the continental slope samples continues to be sorted into the collection.

DEPARTMENT OF ENTOMOLOGY

Research Projects

In February 1988 Dr Arturs Neboiss and Mr Ken Walker joined a two week expedition to the newly proclaimed World Heritage Area in south west Tasmania. The purpose of the expedition, organised by National Parks and Wildlife of Tasmania, was to sample the fauna to provide species lists from which management policies and

plans for the World Heritage Area could be formulated. The two groups of insects of most interest were the aquatic insect group Trichoptera and the terrestrial insect group Apidae (native Australian bees).

Aquatic collecting, was very successful with some 5,000 specimens obtained from numerous sites. Mr Arturs Neboiss and others have been collecting Trichoptera in Tasmania since 1964, so prior to this expedition the Tasmanian fauna outside the World Heritage Area was reasonably well known. Of the 165 Trichoptera species recorded for Tasmania, 135 species were recorded in the World Heritage Area and several of these were new to science. The results of this expedition and previous results relevant to the World Heritage Area were gathered by Mr Neboiss and Mr Walker into a 193 page report on the Trichoptera in this unique area.

The World Heritage Area was divided into seven investigation areas within which data was accumulated from sixty-one different collecting sites. Aquatic insects, in particular Trichoptera, are recognised as excellent indicators of water quality and reflect any changes in the water quality. The results and use of this report will be of immense benefit both for formulation of management decisions and for monitoring of any change in environmental conditions within the World Heritage Area.

Research on the native Australian bee group *Lasioglossum* is progressing well. All collections of this group held in Australian institutions, except those at the Australian Museum, have now been gathered on loan. The sorting of over 30,000 specimens is well under way. The usefulness of this research when completed has already been seen by a number of people and requests for identifications have started to arrive. Those at present interested in this research are working on pollination and envenomation or are involved in behavioural sciences.

Field investigations at Wilsons Promontory National Park were completed, and the immature stages of the endemic Australian caddisfly, *Plectrotarsus gravenhorsti*, were described. The Trichoptera chapter for the **Zoological Catalogue of Australia** has also been completed and prepared for publication.

Extensive collections of freshwater insect larve have been investigated and data prepared for inclusion in future publications.

Curatorial Projects

The task of removing old cork from the wooden drawers and transferring the insects into unit trays continued with success.

Type registration continued throughout the year and all newly described material was entered onto computer.

Approximately 10,000 author's names from our reprint collection have been entered onto the computer and approximately one the general cross-reference information has been entered.

Considerable help was received from volunteers, in particular: Mr and Mrs G. Burns' work on the Jewel beetle (Buprestidae) collection; Mr P. Kelly, work on leafeating beetles (Chrysomelidae); Mr J. Greaves, entering data onto computer.

The European Wasp Exhibition was re-run at the Royal Agricultural Show and won second prize in the Community Services Division. The 210 slide audio-visual on the European Wasp was converted to VHS video and a copy was sent to all Department of Agriculture Stations throughout Victoria (approx. 250). Other copies have been sold through the Museum shop. Bayer Australia Limited provided $22,000 sponsorship for the above exhibition and video production.

Loans

Thirty-six loans were made to institutions within Australia. Nineteen loans were made to overseas institutions.

ENVIRONMENTAL RECORDS

Research Projects

Research continued in both terrestrial and freshwater projects.

Vote funded terrestrial research was concentrated on completion of the Victorian Mallee invertebrate survey. Most of the material collected during the 1985-86 broad-scale survey conducted in collaboration with the National Parks and Wildlife Division and the Flora Survey Unit has been identified. Limited field work was conducted in areas not covered by the original survey, such as the southern edges of the Sunset Country.

The Giant Gippsland Earthworm project (funded by World Wildlife Fund Australia) is well underway. Regular field work to ascertain life histories, population numbers and distribution is conducted. Worm rearing experiments are underway in the Zoology Department at LaTrobe University.

A draft discussion paper funded by the Department of Conservation, Forests and Lands was written on the conservation of non-marine invertebrates and non-vascular plants in relation to the Flora and Fauna Guarantee Act.

A grant from the Australia-China Council and Australian Geographic permitted Dr Yen to undertake a brief survey of the invertebrate fauna of Australian trees and of native rainforest trees in southern China in April-May 1988.

Three grant-funded freshwater projects continued in the Department. The production of a key to the genera of Australian water mites continued into its second year. The effects of physical disturbance on the Acheron River (a joint project with Monash University) also entered its second year. The Thomson River post construction monitoring project was completed, and a report was submitted to the funding agencies.

Field work was conducted in the following areas:
Northern Australia-Darwin, Kakadu, Katherine and the eastern Kimberleys (water mite project).
South-western Western Australia (with mite project).
Guangdong and Hainan Island Provinces, China.
Acheron River (physical disturbance project).
Sunset Country, Victorian Mallee.
South Gippsland (Giant Gippsland Earthworm project).

Curatorial Projects

Mr Ken Walker of the Entomology Department assisted Environmental Records to adapt the Titan database for conversion into species sites tables for getting ecological results using multivariate analysis.

VERTEBRATE ZOOLOGY

The four departments in this section of the division are responsible for the State Collections of fishes, snakes, lizards, tortoises, frogs, mammals and birds.

DEPARTMENT OF ICHTHYOLOGY

Research Projects

The Ichthyological Collection of the Museum of Victoria is rapidly becoming one of the most representative temperate Australian fish collections in Australia. Joint studies with the section of Crustacea and Invertebrate Zoology, on the shelf and slope faunas of the Bass Strait and the south-eastern Australian coast respectively, have generated valuable collection materials and uncovered numerous taxonomic problems that have formed the basis for part of the section's research efforts. Because of the availability of shiptime aboard research vessels capable of sampling at much greater depths than have been previously collected, the focus of the field programme has been directed towards the understanding of mesopelagic, bathypelagic and deep benthic compositions of south-eastern Australian fish communities. This subject forms an integral part of an ARC grant funded programme involving the Marine sections together with the Victorian Institute of Marine Sciences. The aim of the project is to investigate slope communities of south-eastern Australia, an area with extremely important commercial fishing interests, especially at depths being studied.

A major portion of research time in the past six months has been spent modifying and editing a massive compilation of literature treating the marine fishes of Bass Strait and other Victorian waters. This annotated checklist which is to be published as an *Occasional Paper* of the Museum, attempts to present all synonyms and name combinations for more than 800 species, and provides an extensive list of published references treating all aspects of the classification, distribution, biology, ecology and behaviour of each species.

This source will provide a starting point for those people who are embarking on fish related studies but are not intimately familiar with the literature. The Australian Marine Sciences and Technologies Advisory Committee funded project is expected to be submitted for publication towards the end of the year.

The south-eastern stretch of the Australian coastline is especially interesting as it is a transition zone adjacent to a major water mass boundary separating Southern Ocean conditions from those of the subtropical Pacific. Changes in these types of conditions are responsible for the distributional limits of many water dories and gemfish, be they limited by biological factors of the individual species or of the species prey. Distributional information about the entire fauna then provides a basis for further study aimed at resource management.

Recently collected material has brought to light the presence of previously undescribed and unnamed species. In order to bring these and other taxa to the attention of the scientific community and to make available formal names by which they may be referred to, a series of twenty papers describing two new genera and thirty-three new species was prepared to fill Part One of Volume 28 of the **Memoirs of the Museum of Victoria (31 October 1987)**. This international contribution is a significant addition to our understanding of the diversity of Australian fishes.

Some of the more interesting external involvements of the section have been with the State Chemistry Laboratory and a private concern who are developing biochemical standards to be used in checking for fish substitution in the wholesale and retail fish trade. Specimens brought in for 'expert' identification by sectional staff are then tested for protein profiles. Profiles of suspect fish products from markets are compared with the profiles of species under whose name they have been sold.

Curatorial Projects

Recent curatorial efforts have centred on the identification and computer registration of specimens taken in July 1987 on the first SLOPE cruise aboard the CSIRO oceanographic vessel **Franklin**. Information about the 436 lots representing several thousand specimens is electronically manipulated to provide a picture of species distribution in the sites sampled. This allowed the identification of sampling gaps to be filled on the ORV **Franklin** cruise in October 1988.

Sectional field work for the 1987-88 financial year involved participation aboard the CSIRO Fisheries Research Vessel **Soela** sampling demersal fishes along the upper slope between north-eastern Tasmania and southern New South Wales. The two week cruise in May generated an interesting selection of species not yet represented in the Museum's collections.

Loans

Australian institutions were sent eleven loans comprising 610 specimens in eighty-seven lots. Nine loans, 357 specimens in forty-six lots, were made to overseas institutions.

Visitors

Late in March, the section welcomed Dr Nikolay Parin of the P.P. Shirshov Institute of Oceanology, Moscow, perhaps Russia's foremost ichthyologist and certainly one of the Soviet Union's most prolific publishers on deep-sea fishes. Dr Parin was in Australia on a two month research trip and passed on some useful information pertaining to south-eastern Australian species.

DEPARTMENT OF HERPETOLOGY

Research

Work has continued on the herpetofauna of the Victorian Mallee, with field work during the year being concentrated in the area of Sunset Tank, in the Sunset Country. It is envisaged that a short note on this section of the work will be published during the forthcoming year.

Curatorial Projects

Database entry remains the highest priority. This task is now almost thirty per cent complete. Most specimens not already accessioned into the database are accessioned in 'dave' format, which although not yet cleaned, is retrievable.

The collection has been used by Dr G.M. Shea, of Sydney University, who spent two weeks in the Department during January and another week during May. Dr Shea is currently working on the scincid genera *Tiliqua* and *Trachydosaurus*. Dr M. Hutchinson, of LaTrobe University, has spent many days in the Department examining specimens of the *Leiolopisma entrecasteauxii* (grass skinks) complex in which he is currently doing taxonomic research. Dr G.J. Witten, in collaboration with the Curator has continued to work in apparentneotony in the Victorian Big Desert specimens of Jew Lizard (*Pogona vitticeps*.

Loans

During the year loans were made to the Australian Museum, Sydney; the South Australian Museum, Adelaide; and CSIRO Wildlife Research, Canberra.

Acquisitions

A total of 1,144 specimens was registered into the collection during the year. Notable registrations included three species of snakes from the Sunset Country of north-western Victoria which were either poorly known from Victoria, or known only from very old specimens. These species were the Bandy (*Vermicella annulata*), the Coral Snake (*Simoselaps australis*) and the Yellow-faced Whip Snake (*Demansia psammophis*).

DEPARTMENT OF ORNITHOLOGY

Research Projects

With the appointment of Dr L. Christidis as Curator in September 1987, research in the Department is now concentrating on the evolution and systematics of the Australo-Papuan avifauna modern molecular, biochemical and cytogenetic techniques. This work is in conjunction with researchers at the CSIRO and Australian National University in Canberra. Over

the past year, research has centred on the phylogeny and radiation of the Australo-Papuan wrens (Family: Maluridae) and parrots (Order: Psittaciformes). Funding for this study has come from a CSIRO-ANU grant. Dr Christidis was named as a co-convenor for a symposium on 'The Evolution of Australasia's Avifauna' at the International Ornithological Congress to be held in Christchurch, New Zealand, in 1990.

Curatorial Projects

Field collection by staff and exchanges with Australian and overseas museums have added significant specimens to the research collections.

The acquisition of new cabinets has allowed the extensive collection of overseas research skins to be properly housed. Previously they were kept in wooden boxes. Registration and cataloguing of these specimens is still required.

The collection areas are being up-graded to protect against fading from UV radiation.

Mrs Robin Nettleton and Mrs Barbara Ffrench catalogued, re-housed and re-organised the extensive collection of nests.

Acquisitions

A total of 822 bird specimens were received. Of these the most significant were eight skeletons, two frozen specimens and one skin of Australian species received on exchange from CSIRO Canberra.

150 skins, twenty-two formalin specimens, seven alcohol specimens and 188 frozen specimens of species from Papua New Guinea were received from CSIRO Canberra;

- Twenty-three frozen specimens of corellas *Cacatua pastinator* and *C. sanguinea* were received on exchange from Western Australian Museum;
- Twenty-two frozen specimens of species of Tasmanian birds were received on exchange from Queen Victoria Museum;
- Nineteen frozen specimens of various species were received from the South Australian Museum;
- Six study skins were received on exchange from Ville Du Havre Museum D'Histoire Naturelle, France;
- Eighty-nine study skins were received from Mildura Region, Department of Conservation, Forests and Lands;
- Thirty-nine study skins received from Mr R. Weatherly.

Loans

Twenty-three loans were made to Australian institutions, and thirteen received. Two overseas loans were made; to the San Diego Natural History Museum, USA, and to the Transvaal Museum, South Africa. Three loans were received from the National Museum of New Zealand.

Exhibitions

The highly successful **Birds and Gardens** exhibition ran from September 1987 to February 1988 in Spencer Hall. This exhibition contained information on birds of the Melbourne area, plants that attract birds, and other aspects of birds' lives and was curated by the Department. Since the closure of this exhibition the Department has been working with education and photography staff, and the Bird Observers' Club on a video based on the audio-visual in the **Birds and Gardens** exhibition. This video is sponsored by the Department of Conservation, Forests and Lands and will be a joint Bird Observers' Club and Museum of Victoria project.

DEPARTMENT OF MAMMALOGY

Research Projects

Research on Gould's Wattled Bat *Chalinolobus gouldii* has been completed and the manuscript submitted to **Mammalia** for publication.

The completed manuscript of Donald Thomson's Victorian mammal collection has been submitted to the **Victorian Naturalist** for publication.

The diet paper on some of Australia's extinct marsupials has been published.

Final proofs for Chapter 20, of the **Fauna of Australia** Volume 1b, 'Mammals; The Thylacinidae' were completed during the year and publication is imminent.

A short field project was carried out in the Green's Bush area, Mornington Peninsula, in May 1988 and included trapping and photographing mammals.

Curatorial Projects

Documentation of collections has continued. Approximately 11,000 computerised records have been edited to date. In 1987 intern students from the Royal Melbourne Institute of Technology cleaned some and assisted with documentation and maintenance.

Loans

Fifty-four batches were lent to Australian institutions.

Acquisitions

Approximately 120 specimens were acquired during the year. Some were considered suitable for display and have been set aside for that purpose. The following are the main additions to the Collections:

- Cranium and one mandible of *Stenella* sp. a species of dolphin being studied by the Curator.
- Material from the Mallee areas of Victoria including *Ningaui* and *Cercartetus*.
- Specimens of *Burramys parvus* from the Victorian alps.

Exhibitions

Victoria's mammals in **Victoria's National Parks** (Spencer Hall), April 1988.

GRANTS TO NATURAL HISTORY DEPARTMENT

The Australia-China Council provided return air fares for two members of the Shanghai Museum to visit Victoria and for Dr Yen's visit to southern China.

The visit to China by Dr Bowler and Dr Lu was funded by a grant from the Department of Foreign Affairs' Small Activities Scheme.

Australian Biological Resources Study, Taxonomy of Australian Valvifera (Isopoda), $17,850.

Marine Sciences and Technologies Grants Scheme, Benthic, demersal and mesopelagic communities of the South-eastern Australian continental slope, $37,500 (joint between three museum departments and the Victorian Institute of Marine Sciences).

Thomson River Post Construction Monitoring Project, Rural Water Commission, MMBW and Mornington and District Water Board, $37,241.

Water Mite Project, Australian Biological Resources Study $30,000.

Giant Gippsland Earthworm Project, World Wildlife Fund Australia, $8,500.

Physical Disturbances on the Acheron River Project, Australian Water Research Advisory Council (joint project with Monash University), $30,000.

Flora and Fauna Guarantee Discusion Paper Project, Conservation Forests and Lands, $5,000.

Invertebrates on Australian trees in southern China, Australia-China Council, Australian Geographic, $2,700.

DIVISION OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

THE DIVISION has continued to develop innovative and significant programmes throughout 1987-1988.

In evoking past achievements and showcasing recent developments, the Museum is uniquely placed to provide a sharpened perception of current technological issues. It can also act in a catalytic way, opening channels for new thought and experimentation. The Museum obviously cannot take full (or even major) responsibility for the dynamics of scientific innovation but it can serve science and industry by providing much needed contact with the community.

In order to meet these challenges the Museum prepared a proposal for Government consideration for the establishment of a Science and Technology facility at the former MMBW Pumping Station at Spotswood. This scheme proposes construction of a $13.14 million exhibition, storage and curatorial complex which would aim to provide:

- a world class science and technology centre highly activated indoors and outdoors;
- a community facility enabling interest groups to learn from and contribute to our technological heritage;
- a showcase for contemporary science;
- an adjunct to our science education system;
- a repository for the State collections in science and technology and a springboard for new collecting;
- a facility with a vital connection with its western suburbs environment;
- a great entertainment.

This proposal will be assessed by the Government as part of the 1988 - 1989 Budget process.

During this report year, two important new positions have been created within the Division - Senior Curator; and Manager of Science and Technology Programmes. Mr Martin Hallett and Dr Robin Hirst, respectively, have been appointed. In addition, the Division was fortunate to gain the services of Mr Frank Atkinson, formerly the Government printer. Mr Atkinson assisted in preparing a review of the Museum's publication strategy and printing collections.

These appointments enable the Division to approach the large tasks of realising the unfulfilled potential for activity in the area of science and technology.

DEPARTMENT OF ARMS

In December 1987 the Curator of Arms, Mr Ray Fielding, retired. Mr Fielding had been with the Museum since 1966 and had been Curator since 1982. His expertise and dedication have ensured the proper conservation and development of one of the Museum's finest collections.

It was not possible to fill the Curator's position in this report year. In these circumstances the assistance of the Honorary Curator of Arms, Major Ted Millett, has been invaluable in dealing with public enquiries and other curatorial functions.

The Arms collection continues to benefit from the personal generosity of Mr David Alexander whose contributions to the Alexander Arms Fund now total over $5,000.

DEPARTMENT OF ASTRONOMY

Over 80,000 visitors attended the H.V. McKay Planetarium during 1987-88. 45,000 were in booked school groups. In all, some 460 public sessions, 628 school sessions and fifteen special sessions were presented.

Planetarium Director, Dr Robin Hirst, and his staff were active in the production of five new shows: **Where are We; Are We Alone; Eyes to the Skies; Three Minutes to Mercury;** and **Discover the Southern Cross.** All proved extremely popular.

The Planetarium was rented out for a number of commercial product launches. In November it hosted the Australian Astronomy and Space Exploration Liaison Group Conference.

The GOTO planetarium projector is now some 30 years old. Spare parts are becoming difficult and expensive to obtain and certain functions are inoperable. Newer technology means that both the projection quality and special effects capacities of the Museum's equipment are now antiquated. In view of this the Council resolved to establish a Planetarium Replacement Sinking Fund which aims to allocate $100,000 per annum towards projector renewal.

In co-operation with volunteers from the Astronomical Society of Victoria thirty-seven night-viewing sessions for the public and special interest groups were held at the Melbourne Observatory.

DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNICATIONS, ELECTRONICS AND MEDICINE

In response to the Victorian Technology Statement, Curator, Mr Geoffrey Holden, developed a major initiative in the area of medicine this year. A Medical Advisory Panel comprising staff and eminent outside experts was established to aid in the development of the collections and to assist with policy. Its work has resulted in the preparation of a plan to establish a National Medical Museum at the Museum of Victoria. This facility would deal with conservation of items of medical heritage and would address contemporary issues of health and research. Investigations into feasibility and resourcing will continue throughout 1988-1989.

The Museum was also most fortunate to gain the co-operation of Dr Graham Clarke, inventor of the Cochlear Implant (Bionic Ear), in making his collection of research papers, prototypes and associated material available.

The Department was active in the production of a number of exhibitions during the report year. **Good Vibrations** was produced in conjunction with the Victorian Rock Foundation and CSIRO as part of the Bicentennial Rock Spectacular. **Electric Relics** was mounted at the Myer Emporium; and Telecom's **Answer Please** was well received during its six months in the Barry Gallery.

Acquisition has been somewhat hampered by the substantial constraints on storage space faced by all departments in the Division. The Museum was fortunate to receive the donation of the fine shopfittings of an 1880 Fitzroy pharmacy - the kind gift of Mr and Mrs P. Saltys.

DEPARTMENT OF ENGINEERING AND TRANSPORT

Motoring Memories, a major exhibition dealing with the development of Victorian motoring up until 1948, was prepared by the Curator of Engineering and Transport, Mr Bill Sidebottom, with the assistance of consultant curator, Mr John White and the staff of the La Trobe Library.

A unique collection of important vehicles was assembled on generous private loan and from the Museum's own collection including the only remaining cars made in the first ten years of Victorian production: 'the Thompson Steam Car'; 'the Haines and Grut Motor Buggy'; and the '1906 Tarrant'. Also exhibited for the first time was the C.A.C. Deliverette Van, recently acquired by the Museum for $10,000.

The Museum was most grateful for the strong sponsorship support for **Motoring Memories** from the Royal Automobile Club of Victoria and the Victorian Automobile Chamber of Commerce.

In another initiative, a register of extant steam machinery will be created to assist in the identification and conservation of that heritage. Sponsor funding is sought to offset costs underwritten by the Museum Council.

Victorian railway development has been of prime importance in our social and economic history and the model railway collection of the late Mr Alan Goode, which covers the first century of that development, is to be purchased. The collection will be displayed, providing visitors with a unique opportunity to appreciate our railway history.

DEPARTMENT OF NUMISMATICS

The 1987-1988 year proved quite successful in the acquisition of rare collection items. The pattern 1918 Australian shilling was recovered from a Canadian collection offered at auction in Sydney. This unique and little known piece is of the greatest importance for the understanding of post World War I monetary developments and experiments in Australia. It was produced at the Melbourne Mint apparently at the same time as the 1919 shilling (acquired by the collection in 1928). Other important purchases are listed below.

Over 500 items were added by donation, many through the Taxation Incentives for the Arts Scheme. Of particular interest was a small gold medal struck for the 1901 Commonwealth Celebration and issued to Sir John McIntyre, MLA. Sir John's grandson gave this important item to the Museum and has subsequently brought further gold, silver and bronze medals of Sir John's to the Museum, together with some coins brought back to Australia after Sir John toured the United States and Europe in preparing for the 1880 Melbourne Exhibition.

Much of the year was spent in fund raising activities, which were designed to be completed in the next financial year. The first of these occurred in July 1988 and grossed over $400,000. Full details will be reported in the next Annual Report.

The Curator acted as national editor of the prestigious **Journal of the Numismatic Association of Australia** and as Deputy Chairman of the Panel of Examiners for Greek and Roman History for VCE.

DEPARTMENT OF PHOTOGRAPHY AND CINEMATOGRAPHY

The public response to the Photographic Archive Project was strong throughout 1987-1988. Under the supervision of the Curator, Mr Euan McGillivray, it mounted exhibitions in Bendigo, Ballarat, Bairnsdale and Mildura. Development of the programme was due in no small part to major sponsorship by the Bendigo Building Society and a $30,000 grant from The Australian Bicentennial Authority. The Project is of immense importance, as it collates and copies photographs taken before 1939 which are held by 'ordinary' men and women. This is a revolutionary way of accessing the past, as history is usually the domain of the literate and articulate. Photographic records are perhaps the only way of understanding how ordinary people lived and worked, and of recognising their important place in Victoria's history. Already over 4,000 photographs have been copied. The project will make use of the latest laser and computer technology to ensure that people's unique family histories are preserved for historians, researchers and future generations.

The Department has also prepared a preliminary proposal for establishing an Arts Data Bank, drawing together visual material from the collections of the Museum, the National Gallery and the State Library on video disc. Feasibility for commercial release of this product will continue in 1988-1989.

DEPARTMENT OF RURAL SCIENCE

As part of its activities, the Rural Science Department has been involved in building the rural trade literature collection through a number of important acquisitions, including the L.J. Johnson collection from Forbes NSW. Some 10,000 items are now available as an important research source with real potential for publication.

During the period 9-18 February a Summer School involving Museum officers was held at Day's Mill and Farm, Murchison.

Day's Mill is one of the most interesting historical sites in the State. Built about 1865, it is the best preserved and most complete example of a flour mill from the nineteenth century to have survived to the present. Also on the site is a wide range of domestic and farm buildings and artefacts, which provide an extraordinary record of life (as well as milling) in rural Victoria.

The Summer School was jointly organised by a number of government agencies: The Museum; Department of Conservation, Forests and Lands; Ministry for Planning and Environment; Ministry for the Arts; Ministry for Housing and Construction, and the Victorian Archaeological Survey, with the assistance of some thirty-five volunteers. Eight Museum officers under the leadership of the Curator of Rural Science, Mr Martin Hallett and Bill Sidebottom participated.

The primary aims of the School were to assess the milling machinery; to develop a comprehensive inventory of the movable artefacts on the property and fittings in its buildings; and to produce measured drawings of all buildings. It was hoped that through these projects, the groundwork would be laid for the production of full conservation and management plans for the site. Two milling experts (Mr Geoff Wise and Mr Leigh Youdale) worked with School participants to undertake a detailed analysis of the mill and its machinery. While some mysteries remain, a clear understanding of the mill's history and operation has been pieced together. The analysis confirms the significance of the mill as a record of the 'romantic' period of milling by steam and stones.

The inventory project was highly successful. During the nine days of the School almost 8,000 items were physically handled, examined, identified, measured, catalogued, tagged and photographed, and the information about them keyed to computer. The processing of this large number of items is a tribute to the enthusiasm and competence of the School's leaders and volunteers.

Mr Gary Vines has been employed on National Estate grant funds for three months to write up the data from the field work and to integrate it into a full report.

Mr Hallett has also commenced work on a project which aims to index rare Patent records to 1890. This material is presently difficult to access for researchers, but offers a rich source of information on Victorian inventiveness and the development of manufacturing.

Divisional Registrar

Registrar Ms Ruth Leveson and Curators Mr Martin Hallett and Mr Geoff Holden have contributed substantially to the Museum's efforts to implement an adequate computer collection record system. Until this work is complete and appropriate hardware is acquired the Division's Data Base will not meet requirements for stock control, research and exhibition design.

Research Scientist

Dr Hayden Downing completed work on the compilation of **Scientific Equipment Makers** - a catalogue of London makers between 1840 and 1900. The catalogue will now be sold in three versions: microfiche; printed and computer disc.

Major Acquisitions

July 1987:	Proof 1939 Kangaroo Australian Halfpenny; purchased.
August 1987:	Pattern Australian Token Penny struck for Sydney Tea Stores. 'Four Line' type. One of four known; purchased.
November 1987:	Gold Medal awarded to Sir John McIntyre (Donation from Mr John W. McIntyre, Grandson of Sir John).
March 1988:	Pattern Australian Shilling 1918 struck in .500 Silver. Unique; purchased.
	Trial Australian Threepence 1918 from defaced dies. One of two known; purchased.

DIVISION OF PUBLIC PROGRAMMES

THE DIVISION of Public Programmes had a very active year. The exhibitions schedule was varied with all curatorial divisions contributing to the programme. The Museum committed itself to a new permanent gallery and was host to a number of national and international exhibitions. The Museum also staged an exhibition in Auckland, New Zealand.

Through the activities of the Community Services Programme, the Division expanded its role as a provider of services to the disadvantaged. Services to rural communities were increased dramatically through the exhibition, education and community service programmes.

The Museum's commercial operations continued to provide an expanding revenue base. The commercial operation of the Photography Section was notable for the expansion of its services to the public. The highlight of the year was the visit to the Museum by Her Majesty Queen Elizabeth II to officially open the exhibition **First Impressions - The British Discovery of Australia**.

EDUCATION SERVICE SECTION

The Museum Education Service provided support for visiting school groups and teachers. Approximately 200,000 students passed through the Museum in 1987-1988. The Service made good use of the Museum Exhibitions Programme and produced education kits linking exhibition content with the school curriculum. Education kits were produced for the following exhibitions: Esso's **Return of the Dinosaurs; Motoring Memories; Salinity - Salt and the Earth; Birds and Gardens,** and **The Dinner Party**.

Kits were produced also for two Bicentennial travelling exhibitions **First Impressions** and **Shipwreck**. The Education Service is preparing a kit for a new permanent exhibition: **Koorie - 40,000 Years of Australian Aboriginal Culture**.

The Education Service staged a successful programme in Sale where Esso's **Return of the Dinosaurs** was presented. 6,000 school children visited this exhibition at the Gippsland Centre, Sale. The Education Service ran conjoint programmes in rural areas with the Community Services Section of the Museum.

Programmes using the Museum Collections were run in the subject areas of aboriginal studies, natural history and science and technology. These programmes provide students with hands-on experience and activities. The Education Service played a significant role in the operation of the Planetarium and assisted the Curator of Astronomy in preparing programmes for a predominantly school-based audience.

The Service continued to be a destination for interstate and overseas colleagues. Staff participated in the conferences of the Science Teachers Association of Victoria and the Museum Education Association of Australia.

COMMUNITY SERVICES SECTION

In line with Victoria's Social Justice Strategy, the Museum of Victoria is committed to enabling the community at large to gain its basic entitlement to view, research, learn from and enjoy the cultural heritage held in the Museum Collections. The Community Services Section facilitates this process through activities and tours within the Museum and, beyond the walls of the Museum, through the Outreach Programme.

Over the last twelve months, the position of Co-ordinator of Volunteers was extended to full-time and the position of Outreach Co-ordinator was established with the assistance of funds provided by the Lance Reichstein Foundation.

The Community Services Section mounted and initiated programmes to reach the wider community. Through its initiatives in improv-

ing publicity, increasing 'hands-on' interactive experiences and general public relations work, the Community Services section has:

- increased numbers of visitors;
- encouraged 'return visits' by families and groups;
- attracted visitors from sections of the community which have not visited the Museum, improved services for groups of local and overseas visitors;
- improved services for groups of local and overseas visitors;
- generated income through tour charges and public donations;
- provided access to the Museum for less mobile people;

Through these Community Service activities, the Museum's links are being strengthened with:

- community leisure and learning groups;
- educational institutions particularly in adult education and further education programmes;
- local councils;
- welfare groups;
- migrant groups;
- the tourist industry;
- publicity and information services.

The Community Services Department is providing an important link between the Museum's resources and the community. Demand for Museum services is extremely high and growing rapidly as awareness of the Museum's community programmes increases.

PUBLIC RELATIONS

The appointment of a full-time Public Relations Officer has had a significant impact on the public profile of the Museum. The Public Relations Officer has arranged exhibition openings and events, prepared media releases and press kits for major exhibitions and events, and organised radio and television coverage. In addition, newsworthy activities within the Museum obtained media attention.

The Public Relations Officer also answered public enquiries concerning the Museum and its programmes. This ensured friendly contact between the institution and the enquiring public.

The Public Relations Officer assisted and advised on the production of exhibition catalogues, education kits, posters, publications, brochures and the Annual Report.

CHILDREN'S MUSEUM

The Children's Museum recorded another highly successful year. Programmes were staged on the human body and its health. These included the programme 'Living Lungs', which was run in conjunction with student teachers from Victoria College, 'Deafness Awareness Week' in conjunction with the Deafness Foundation, and 'Dental Health Week'. Further extending the Children's Museum's emphasis on health and the living body, the 'Everybody Exhibition' began its tour throughout Victoria. Over the next three years the exhibition will visit rural and urban centres. The first twelve months of the programme is funded by a $100,000 sponsorship from the Victorian Health Promotion Fund.

The Children's Museum ran workshops on postcard manufacture, nature printing and 'small things'. The Discovery Room continued to provide hands-on experiences for visitors.

Special activities were arranged for Children's Week and a five-week 'Young Museologist's Course' was also run for young people interested in, or wanting to work in, museums.

A Ministerial review was undertaken on the future operations of the Children's Museum. This special facility will now operate as a private enterprise within the Museum of Victoria.

COMMERCIAL OPERATIONS

The Museum's commercial operations provide a service to the visiting public and generates revenue for the Museum Council. The shop achieved successful souvenir sales from marketing programmes linked to the temporary exhibition programmes of the Museum. The Russell Street shop has been developed to specifically cater for large, temporary exhibitions and for children. The Swanston Street shop now caters for the 'upper-end' of the market by stocking books, postcards, museum-ware, relicas and high quality souvenirs.

To develop a strong commercial presence, the Museum has franchised the operation of the Coffee Shop to Dennis Catering, a member of the Ballantyne Group. In line with this, the Museum is now taking steps to franchise the operation of its two souvenir shops.

The Museum has established a successful commercial arm in the Photography Section of the Museum Resource Service. The report of the Photography Section may be found below.

MUSEUM RESOURCE SERVICE

The Museum Resource Service has had a productive year. Each section continued to develop its expertise as a team for exhibition production, installation and maintenance. Each section has established and continues to develop its specialist skills. Owing to the demand from both in-house and travelling exhibitions, services to the Planetarium and curatorial

programmes have been reduced. It is anticipated that changes in staffing and the structure of the Exhibitions Programme will facilitate more effective delivery of services to curatorial departments in the year 1988-1989.

The Museum Resource Service has installed exhibitions offsite throughout Victoria. This includes the Salinity exhibition which is travelling throughout rural Victoria. The **Dinner Party** exhibition at the Royal Exhibition Building and Conference Centre and Esso's **Return of the Dinosaurs** Exhibition at the Gippsland Centre, Sale and the Westpac Travelling Exhibition.

CONSTRUCTION WORKSHOP

The Construction Workshop has contributed to the production of every exhibition within the Museum. The development of the modular panel system for construction has led to further efficiencies in design production by allowing standardisation of information and graphic panels.

The Workshop has continued to improve its efficiency by upgrading equipment to more automated operation. This has facilitated the adoption of faster track construction and a shorter turn-around time for exhibitions.

Workshop staff have contributed skill and creative ideas to the design of exhibitions. Many innovations have developed from the willingness of this group to undertake complex construction tasks.

TECHNICAL WORKSHOP

Staff in the Technical Workshop have been upgraded to the level of Technical Officers. A TAFE course at certificate level has been identified as the base qualification for staff in this area and accepted by the Public Service Board. This will ensure that staff will have the high level of technical skill required for their expanded role in the Museum.

Staff have continued to develop their expertise in the production of lighting effects for exhibitions. The Museum is now becoming better equipped to provide light, sound and audio-visual support to exhibitions. The process of upgrading equipment and facilities will continue.

This group is now an integral part of the exhibition production team and provides creative and practical input into the production of exhibitions and the supervision of their installation.

Regular services were provided to the H.V. McKay Planetarium and the Children's Museum, and restoration work and dressing was undertaken on motor vehicles in the transport collection prior to display in the Motoring Memories Exhibition.

PHOTOGRAPHY SECTION

The Photography Section has two arms: one provides services to the Museum and its Exhibitions Programme; the other services to the Commercial Operations of the Museum. The Commercial Operations programme continues to expand revenue generation by the Museum. Funds which have been invested in more efficient equipment have benefited the Museum's Commercial Operations and also the capacity of the Photography Section to service curatorial and exhibition needs. The Commercial Operations work in co-operation with the State Library of Victoria to provide efficient and cost effective service to the public requiring photographic reproductions from the Library. In addition, services are provided to other museums, particularly regional museums and historic societies. This work brings a high standard of display within economic reach of these smaller groups which relate to a wide general public. Such groups include the Queenscliff Maritime Museum, the Italian Historic Society, the Pepper Heritage Museum at Deniliquin and the Stockman's Hall of Fame at Longreach.

The Photographic Section continues to provide photographic and audio-visual production for exhibitions. Notable productions included an audio-visual display for the **Birds and Gardens** exhibition and a video for Esso's **Return of the Dinosaurs**. A video programme was also produced from the audio-visual programme used in the **European Wasp Exhibition**. This will be distributed throughout Australia for educational purposes by Bayer Australia, the sponsor of the exhibition.

In addition to routine curatorial work, special curatorial services were provided for scholarly publications by staff in the Division of Human Studies and Natural History. Photographic documentation was prepared for the Division of Science and Technology on Day's Flour Mill at Murchison and the Goode Model Railway.

Significant documentation and display production was undertaken for the Planetarium and the Museum Exhibitions Programme in particular, a careful photorecord is being made of the field and technical aspects of the production of the Koorie Exhibition. A transparency file is being established to allow systematic access to the extensive working photo archive of the Photography Section.

As a result of the increasing use of photographic murals, back-lit transparencies and audio-visual techniques the Museum's exhibitions are becoming increasingly versatile in the delivery of interpretative material to visitors.

PREPARATORS SECTION

The Preparators Section has had an active year with the focus on contributions to the Exhibitions Programme. Curatorial work continued at a steady pace, however, more attention will need to be given to these programmes in 1988-1989.

The exhibition work by the Preparators reflects renewed interest in dioramas as an exhibition technique and a new trend to the use of set pieces for open display in exhibitions.

Set pieces and dioramas were constructed for the exhibitions **Motoring Memories**, Esso's **Return of the Dinosaurs, Birds and Gardens, Shipwreck!** and the Victorian Government Pavilion at Expo 88.

The Greater Glider Diorama in McCoy Hall is being replaced by a Platypus Diorama. Construction of this diorama has been temporarily halted owing to work on the Lake Condah Diorama for the Koorie Exhibition in Kershaw Hall. This will be the largest diorama in Australia and will depict a campsite scene at the Lake Condah stone village and fish trap site in Western Victoria.

Birds were prepared for the **Birds and Gardens** exhibition, and birds and mammals prepared for case displays on the **Birds and Mammals of Victoria's National Parks**. In addition, other large marsupials were mounted.

Fossil replicas were prepared for sale in the Museum shop. Replicas of three Cranbourne meteorites were prepared for Cranbourne Shire Council and a giant Gippsland earthworm was replicated in a habitat setting for permanent display at Coal Creek Historic Park, Korumburra.

Aboriginal artefacts were replicated for the Division of Human Studies and Education Services and for the Power House Museum.

The section also participated in International Museums Day activities.

Mr Michael Traynor, now an Honorary Curator of the Museum, retired on 27 November 1987 after thirty-eight years service as a Preparator. His contribution as Preparator and subsequently Senior Preparator has been outstanding.

DESIGN SECTION

The Design Section has maintained a high standard and volume of output despite the loss of skilled staff. The Section continues to develop its approach to museum design, with particular attention given this year to experimentation with graphic presentation within exhibitions.

The following exhibitions were designed and produced in-house:

Museum on a Platter
Esso's Return of the Dinosaurs
Motoring Memories
Victoria Regina
Birds and Gardens
Westpac Travelling Photographic Exhibition
Giant Gippsland Earthworm Display
Medical Research Travelling Exhibition
Phar Lap Altogether
Victorian Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Trust Exhibition
Birds and Mammals of Victoria's National Parks
Clock Display
Recent Acquisitions Case

In addition, artwork was prepared for the Trades Hall Archive Project and the Museum Photographic Archive Project. Assistance was given to the contract designers of the following exhibitions: **Salinity, The Dinner Party, The Great 1888 Exposition, Another Day Another Dollar** and **Artwork Exhibition.** Assistance was given to the Sunrise School Project and the Section conducted a site investigation and prepared detailed documentation and a report on the Goode Model Railway for the Division of Science and Technology.

The Section prepared artwork for three Planetarium shows: 'Three Minutes to Mercury', 'Eyes to the Skies' and 'Discover the Southern Cross'.

The Section participated in the installation of the Bicentennial Exhibition, **First Impressions** and **The Dinner Party**.

The major thrust for the designers is the design and production of the Koorie Exhibition, perhaps the most ambitious permanent exhibition to be undertaken by the Museum.

Summary of Exhibitions Held Between July 1987 and June 1988

WESTPAC BICENTENNIAL TRAVELLING MUSEUM

28 January 1987 - 11 February 1988

This exhibition was a historical display including the gold rush days and early Australian pioneering. It was opened by the Manager of Westpac, Mr Brenton Whitford, at 360 Collins Street Melbourne, and sponsored by Westpac and supported by local historical societies.

The Westpac Travelling Museum also was opened by the Westpac Manager, Mr Doug Broadley, at 447 Bourke Street on 15 February 1988 and finished on 25 February 1988.

PHANTARAMA - THE ORIGINS OF MOVING PICTURES

25 February 1987 - 31 August, 1987

This exhibition featured the discoveries and inventions of the 19th century that led to the development of 'moving pictures' being the forerunners of today's movies'. It was opened by The Hon. Race Mathews MP, Minister for the Arts, and sponsored by the Australian Film Institute.

'MUSEUM ON A PLATTER' - VIDEODISC

14 April 1987 - July 1987

A high technology exhibition showing the use of computers a museum to provide the public with museum related information. This exhibition involved memory technology, videodisc technology and touch screens.

ESSO'S RETURN OF THE DINOSAURS EXHIBITION

30 April 1987 - 10 August 1987

This exhibition contained visual displays of dinosaurs from Australia, Canada and China. It also travelled to the Auckland Museum in New Zealand, Sale in Victoria, and the Queen Victoria Museum and Art Gallery in Launceston, Tasmania.

Esso's **Return of the Dinosaurs** exhibition in Melbourne was opened by The Hon. John Cain MP, Premier of Victoria, and sponsored by Esso Australia Limited, Quantas and Channel 10.

ROYAL MELBOURNE INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY (RMIT) CENTENARY MEMORABILIA EXHIBITION

2 June 1987 - 6 July 1987

The RMIT exhibition included the display of photographs, trophies, presentations and other memorabilia collected over 100 years. The exhibition was opened by The Hon. Evan Walker MLC, Minister for Agriculture and Rural Affairs and Minister Responsible for Major Projects.

NUMISMATICS DISPLAY - VICTORIA REGINA

15 July 1987

Display of medals relating to the reign of Queen Victoria. A project privately sponsored by Mrs Eva Hardy, who also lent many special items for exhibit.

MEDICAL RESEARCH TRAVELLING EXHIBITION (on behalf of Howard Florey Institute)

August 1987

Based on an earlier exhibition on Medical Research held at the Museum, this exhibition was redesigned as a travelling exhibition and toured by the Howard Florey Institute, University of Melbourne.

GIANT GIPPSLAND EARTHWORM DISPLAY (on behalf of Coal Creek Historic Park)

September 1987

The Museum produced a permanent exhibition for display at Coal Creek Historic Park at Korumburra.

BIRDS AND GARDENS

3 September 1987 - 1 February 1988

An exhibition with strong visual appeal, it combined living and preserved plants, mounted birds and audiovisual material. Different types of garden environments were shown with a view to conveying information about ways of providing food, shelter, nesting sites and water for birds. It was opened by the Honorary Curator of Ornithology, Mr Graham Pizzey, and sponsored by Ern A.B. Linton Nursery.

'MOTORING MEMORIES' EXHIBITION

18 September 1987 - 31 January 1988

The first fifty years of motoring in Victoria, from 1898 to 1948, was depicted in this extensive exhibition. It was opened by Senator The Hon. John Button, M.P., Minister for Industry, Technology and Commerce. The project was sponsored by the Victorian Automobile Chamber of Commerce (VACC) and by the Royal Automobile Club of Victoria Limited (RACV).

SALINITY: SALT AND THE EARTH

22 October 1987 - now travelling

This exhibition explains the salinity problems by showing the massive destruction caused when salt stops plants from getting nutrients from the soil. It is a travelling exhibition and is scheduled to visit thirteen Victorian country centres. The exhibition was opened by The Hon. Evan Walker MLC, Minister for Agriculture and Rural Affairs, and sponsored by the Victorian Salinity Programme.

SALINITY EXHIBITION (Bendigo)

10 February 1988 - 29 February 1988

The exhibition was opened by The Hon. Joan Kirner MLC, Minister for Conservation, Forests and Lands, at the MacGillivray Hall, TAFE College, Bendigo.

SALINITY EXHIBITION (Echuca)

6 May 1988 - 24 May, 1988

The exhibition was opened by Mr Paul Clarkson, Director of Ministry for the Arts, at the Paramont Arts Activity Centre in Echuca.

SALINITY EXHIBITION (Mildura)

28 June 1988 - 19 July, 1988

The exhibition was opened by The Hon. Tom Roper MP, Minister for Planning and Environment, at the Mildura Arts Centre, Mildura.

SALINITY EXHIBITION (Horsham)

12 August 1988 - 29 August 1988

The exhibition was opened by Ms. Heather Mitchell, President of the Victorian Farmers' Federation, at the State Education Centre.

PHAR LAP EXHIBITION

28 October 1987 - December 1988

Phar Lap, Australia's great champion horse on display together with photos, memorabilia and historical information about him. This exhibition was opened by well known jockey, Mr Roy Higgins, and sponsored by the State Insurance Office.

VICTORIAN ABORIGINAL HERITAGE TRUST EXHIBITION

30 October 1987 - 1 May 1988

The exhibition featured Victorian Aboriginal cultural items of historical importance: boomerangs, historical photographs, shields, baskets, stone axes, etc. The Governor General of Australia, His Excellency the Right Honourable Sir Ninian Stephen, A.K., G.C.M.G., G.C.V.O., K.B.E., opened this exhibition.

NUMBER PLEASE - THE STORY OF TELEPHONISTS IN VICTORIA

23 November 1987 - 26 June 1988

The exhibition showed the role of telephonists in the telephone network from the 1880s to the present day. Visitors were able to watch Telecom employees operate a modern directory assistance set-up and see a re-creation of the first Melbourne Telephone Exchange. This exhibition was opened by the Chairman of Telecom Australia, Mr Robert Brack, and sponsored by Telecom Australia Limited.

DINNER PARTY EXHIBITION

17 January - 27 March, 1988

American artist Ms Judy Chicago conceived the idea of ceramic and embroidered installation celebrating women in history. The production of 'The Dinner Party' involved 400 artists over five years. This exhibition, which has travelled throughout the world, was held at the Royal Exhibition Building and Conference Centre and was sponsored by K.L. Ballantyne Pty. Ltd. The Hon. John Cain MP, Premier of Victoria, opened the exhibition.

THE GREAT EXPOSITION - Melbourne Theatre Writers Group

1 March 1988 - 30 March 1988

The Great Exposition consisted of a sequence of plays. The theme for the plays was based on the Great Exhibition Centennial in Melbourne in 1888. This programme was sponsored by the State Insurance Office.

'ANOTHER DAY ANOTHER DOLLAR' - Australian Council of Trade Unions (ACTU)

18 March 1988 - December 1988

This exhibition shows the history of working lives in Australia. It was opened by the President of the ACTU, Mr Simon Crean, and sponsored by Australian Airlines, Brambles, and the Australian Paper Manufacturers.

'FIRST IMPRESSIONS' - The British Discovery of Australia

28 April 1988 - 3 July 1988

This exhibition, designed and produced by the British Museum of Natural History, London, examined early European voyages to Australia and the history of English exploration and settlement of Australia, and included artistic collections of Australian flora and fauna made by Sir Joseph Banks. It was opened by Her Majesty The Queen of Australia on 28 April 1988 and was sponsored by Citibank and Australian Airlines.

'BONANZA' - Gold in Victoria Bicentennial Exhibition

17 May 1988 - May 1989

This exhibition displayed Australian gold nuggets and other gold items. The 'Pride of Australia' nugget was handed over to the Museum of Victoria by the State Bank of Victoria. The exhibition opened by Mr. Arnold Hancock, Chairman of the State Bank of Victoria, and sponsored by Gold Corp of Australia.

PHAR LAP ALTOGETHER

27 May 1988 - December 1988

Phar Lap's heart arrived at the Museum of Victoria on loan from the National Museum in Canberra till December 1988. This exhibition includes Phar Lap and his trophies, and saddle. The display is sponsored by the State Insurance Office.

ARTWORK EXHIBITION

23 June 1988 - 18 August 1988

For this exhibition ten artists from the Victorian Arts Workshop were commissioned by various unions and union committees to make banners, murals and illustrations about union workers and their lives. It was opened by the Incoming President of the Victorian Trades Hall Council Mr Ron Luckman and sponsored by J.N. Zigouras and Company, Barristers and Solicitors and the People's Hall Society Limited.

SCHOOL OF THE FUTURE PROJECT - Sunrise School

30 June 1988

An ongoing project jointly undertaken by the Australian Council for Educational Research (ACER) and the Museum of Victoria.

This exhibition was opened by Senator John Button, Minister for Science and Technology, and sponsored by Metropolitan Transit; Ministry for Education; Knowledge Victoria; Apple Computers; Barson Computers; Sony Australia, and Telecom Australia Limited.

EXPO 88 BRISBANE - Victorian Pavilion

The Preparator's Department constructed two dioramas for display at Expo 88 in Brisbane.

DIVISION OF HUMAN STUDIES

THE MAJOR themes for the year's activities were staffing, collections management and exhibitions.

Staffing

Two permanent staff were appointed during the year. The position of Registrar was filled in mid-July by Ms Julia Findlay, and the Victorian Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Unit was brought to full strength in December with the appointment of Ms Lori Richardson as the second Liaison Officer.

Several special projects required that a number of temporary appointments be made.

Towards the beginning of the year, Ms Nellie Zola became exhibition curator for the Museum of Victoria/ACTU Working People's History Project (see Exhibitions).

The Department of History assumed a consultancy for the development of display briefs and the gathering of a museum collection for the Australian Stockman's Hall of Fame and outback Heritage Centre in Longreach, Queensland. Ms Liza Dale was employed from December to work on the project. In the same month, Ms Suzanne Hunt was appointed Curator in the History Department, primarily to develop collections and research in the areas relating to home, family and children in Victoria.

The Victorian Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Trust joined with the Museum of Victoria in establishing a permanent exhibition in Kershaw Hall, resulting in the October appointment of Ms Melanie Raberts as Research Officer, and of Ms Chris Hogarth, in January, as Exhibition Curator, both with funds provided by the Trust.

Ms Gael Ramsay was seconded for three months to work on the Continuum Exhibition (bark paintings to Japan), and Robert Burns was employed from February to May in replacement.

In April the Human Rights and Equal Opportunity Commission funded a sixth-month project for the development of an exhibition brief and sponsorship proposal. Ms Zola was appointed to carry out the project.

Collections Management

With the appointment of the Collections Manager, procedures were developed for the proper care and maintenance of the collections. The creation of a computer catalogue assumed a high profile and nearly all staff, as well as a number of volunteers, were participants. Loans and artefact movements were brought under rigid control, and new paths were initiated for keeping track of recent acquisitions between receipt and storage.

Exhibitions

Staff made a prominent impact on exhibitions. The popular **Another Day, Another Dollar** was opened by Mr Simon Crean in March, the Australian Stockman's Hall of Fame and Outback Heritage Centre exhibition at Longreach, Queensland, was opened in April, and the Victorian Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Trust temporary exhibition in Kershaw Hall, opened in November, was dismantled in May to make way for the permanent exhibition **Koorie**, to be opened in December 1988. Staff also coordinated research for the **Motoring Memories** exhibition (August to January), worked on **Bonanza - Gold in Victoria**, and remounted **Phar Lap and Racing History** to coincide with Cup Week.

More detailed summaries for the activities of each Department are presented below.

ABORIGINAL STUDIES

For the Department of Aboriginal Studies, the year has been one largely of consolidation, working very closely with the Collections Manager in computerisation and storage and loans control of the collections. As a result, message sticks, boomerangs, nets, carved boab nuts, playing sticks and bark paintings are now under computer control, and items from other collections are being added. A little over ten per cent of the 70,000 Aboriginal items have now been computer catalogued.

Other major collections management tasks consisted of rolling Aboriginal textiles onto tubes, and the fumigation and cleaning of the Aboriginal plaster busts. Many loans and photographic requests were processed by staff, and a number of requests for the return of skeletal material housed in the Museum were dealt with.

The Department has also applied for funds in support of a videodisc project involving the entire Aboriginal photographic collection.

In addition, the Department has been involved in a number of exhibitions. In August, advice was provided to the Stockman's Hall of Fame project on the Aboriginal component of the exhibition, and in October the Victorian Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Trust temporary exhibition originally mounted in Spencer Hall was remounted in Kershaw Hall. A fibre crafts exhibition at Ararat Gallery in February largely presented Australian Aboriginal material. Departmental staff were also deeply involved with the development of the Victorian Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Trust permanent exhibition in Kershaw Hall.

Major acquisitions during the year were the result of a trip by the Curator, Aboriginal Studies, to Central Australia where mainly women's craft and art were collected.

Donald Thomson Collection

Miss Judith Wiseman completed the typing of Thomson's field notes, and work continued on the cataloguing of the Central Australian photographs.

The Curator was seconded to work on a project taking bark paintings to Japan and was later away on maternity leave.

VICTORIAN ABORIGINAL CULTURAL HERITAGE UNIT

With the appointment of the second Aboriginal Liaison person in December, the Unit was brought to full strength. In February, an extremely successful workshop for Aboriginal communities on the preservation of cultural material was held at the Museum. By April, the majority of cultural officers and their communities had been contacted and had been made aware of the facilities and services being made available by the Museum. The Unit reports that loan applications are increasing, and that there is an expanding interest in and requests for information on Aboriginal history.

The Unit has helped with various aspects of the exhibition **Koorie** to be staged in Kershaw Hall. It provides a major resource for tour groups visiting the Museum, and in June it hosted the Australian Institute of Aboriginal Studies executive meeting.

Prints and negatives in the South-eastern Aboriginal photographic collection, consisting of over 400 images, have been completely copied using funds provided by the Victorian Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Trust.

VICTORIAN ABORIGINAL HERITAGE TRUST

The Trust's prime activity has been the preparation of **Koorie**, a long-term exhibition being installed in Kershaw Hall which traces the 40,000 year old cultural heritage of the Aboriginal people of south-eastern Australia. Sponsorship contributions from the Australian Bicentennial Authority, the Federal and State governments, corporations and private organisations have ensured that the exhibition will proceed as envisaged.

Other major Trust activities included a temporary exhibition **Victoria's Aboriginal Heritage** in Kershaw Hall, an exhibition of contemporary Koorie art at Doncaster in May and June, and a Koorie arts and crafts festival in Kershaw Hall during Heritage Week.

The Trust continued its purchasing programme for Victorian Aboriginal cultural heritage.

HISTORY

Consultancies within the History Department enabled the appointment of additional staff. An active acquisitions programme was undertaken and about 1,000 items have been added to the collection. Specific research and collecting emphases have been on: friendly societies and trade unions; craft; costume and textiles; and childhood and child rearing. With the

help of volunteers, some of the accessioning backlog has been overcome, and the computerisation of the collections continues.

The History Department has been involved in a number of exhibitions, including **Motoring Memories; Phar Lap and Racing History; Another Day Another Dollar; Bonanza - Gold in Victoria; Artwork, The Story of Victoria;** Staff have been consultants to the Australian Gallery of Sport, the Stockman's Hall of Fame and Outback Heritage Centre, and the Human Rights Commission.

Loans

Loans were made to:

Antique Fair at Stonnington
Artwork Exhibition
Ephemera Society
Footscray Institute of Technology Nursing School
Museums Association, Victorian Branch
Women's Christian Temperance Union

Collections Management

Collections Management staff are involved in many aspects of activities carried out in other Departments and referred to in those contexts. In amplification, a major concern of all departments has been computer control of the collection, as this is essential to the efficient operation of Divisional procedures for processing loans and receipting the acquisition of new collections.

Other Collections Management tasks requiring considerable time were to maintain internal movement records, organise insurance for material leaving the building for conservation, arrange for transportation of material going out on loan, liaise with Conservation regarding condition reports, and assist with public enquiries.

OCEANIC STUDIES

Collections from Vanuatu, Niue, Trobriand Islands, Kinomere Island and Tierra del Fuego were brought under computer control. Complete stocktakes have been made of the Vanuatuan, Niuean and Tierra del Fuegan collections.

Loans of fibre artefacts from Kinomere Island were made to the Ararat Gallery, two J.W. Lindt photographs were lent to the Australian National Gallery, and a major contribution to the **Yoruba** exhibition at La Trobe University was made using Christensen Fund collections.

The Curator, Oceanic Studies, was appointed Secretary of the Science and Humanities Committee which administers the Thomas Ramsay Science and Humanities Scholarship.

Acquisitions

Aboriginal eel trap and baskets.
Ceremonial objects from Vanuatu, 1960's.
Children's furniture.
Complete equipment from a Roman Catholic tennis club in Kew.
Costumes 1888-1940.
Craft items made by Aboriginal people during Heritage Week.
Domestic and trade items.
Early Australian dolls and toys.
Furniture from Queen Victoria Hospital site.
Jewellery, domestic items, toys and material from a boy's home.
Pen and ink sketches by Tommy McRae.
Prize winning hand knitting of the 1950's.
Sampler of about 1912.
Scottish silver (two pieces) of about 1860's.
Sepik drum.
Temperance banner.
Trade union and domestic material.
Travelling trunk, 1880's.
Woodworking items.

THE SCIENCE AND HUMANITIES COMMITTEE OF THE MUSEUM OF VICTORIA COUNCIL

The Science and Humanities Committee appointed the well known environmental poet, Mr Mark O'Connor as the Thomas Ramsay Science and Humanities Scholar for 1987. Mr O'Connor has produced a large number of poems relating to the Museum's collections and activities. These poems will be published in the near future. Mr O'Connor received considerable publicity and successfully promoted the scholarship and its aims.

Publication of the work of Mr Colin Finney, the 1986 Thomas Ramsay Science and Humanities Scholar, is in progress. This work is a history of natural history in Australia. A grant of $11,500 was received from the Jack Brockhoff Foundation to assist with this project.

Mr Graham Pizzey, the well known naturalist and author, has been commissioned to write a biography of Crosbie Morrison.

The 1987 Crosbie Morrison Lecture was delivered by Professor George Seddon, Dean of the Faculty of Architecture and Planning and Director of the Centre Environmental Studies at the University of Melbourne. Professor Seddon's lecture was entitled 'The Man From Snowy River - Alfred Howitt and His Heirs'.

The 1988 Crosbie Morrison lecture was brought forward to coincide with the lecture programme for the Bicentennial exhibition, **First Impressions**. The lecture 'First Impressions, Last Chances' was delivered by Professor Carrick Chambers, Director of the Royal Botanic Gardens, Sydney.

With deep regret the Committee accepted the resignation of Sir Thomas Ramsay. Sir Thomas has served the Committee since 1979 and his contribution to the work of the Committee has been outstanding. Sir Thomas endowed the scholarship which now bears his name.

Visitors

Aboriginal Legal Service
Ararat Art Gallery
Asia Society
Australia Council
Australian Museum
Australian National Maritime Museum
Australian National University
Ballarat Aboriginal Co-op
Bay Books
Cambridge University
Children's Museum
Dandenong Aborigines Co-op
Department of Aboriginal Affairs, Canberra
Dja Dja Wrung Aboriginal Association
Doncaster Gallery
Echuca Aboriginal Co-op
Educational Media
Healesville Aboriginal Cooperative
Health Department, Victoria
Institute of Catholic Education
International Association of Doll Makers and Teachers
James Cook University
La Trobe University
Linden Museum
Melbourne University Archives
Migration and Settlement Museum
Ministry for Planning and Environment
Monash University
Museum of Migration
Myer Foundation
National Trust
National Museum of Ireland
Pentridge Education Centre
Police Museum
Power House Museum
Preston Technical and Further Education
South Australian Museum
State Library
Sydney University
Taranaki Museum
University of Queensland
University of Saskatchewan, Canada
University of Wollongong
Victoria Archaeological Survey
Victorian Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Trust
Warrnambool Aboriginal Co-op
Western Australian Museum

DIVISION OF MANAGEMENT SERVICES

THE DIVISION provides support services in the areas of accounting, staffing, stores, transport, library, building security and maintenance.

It continued to consolidate the administrative services of the Museum, despite difficulties encountered with the re-organisation of the structure.

BUILDING AND PROPERTY

Substantial progress was made during the year on the medium term programme of works developed for the Museum/State Library Building Complex. The Ministry of Housing and Construction and the Central Office of the Ministry for the Arts worked with officers of the Museum's Building and Property Section to successfully complete the Annual Provisions programme of works and to complete parts of the Project Provisions programme of works. Implications concerning the future use of the building and the provision of new facilities as envisaged under the proposed Museum/State Library redevelopment, delayed the commencement of several major works planned under this programme. Details relating to the Works Programme are outlined in the report of the Building Management Committee.

FINANCE

During the year a number of major changes occurred. The most important of these was the transfer of Council Accounts from the FBS System to the FM80 System. As a resultof this action, the audit trail for Council Accounts has been enhanced. Leasing arrangements for the Coffee Shop were established on 30 August 1987. This has relieved the Finance Branch of the task of daily processing of small food accounts.

Financial reporting from the FM80 System has been further improved by the provision of monthly project reports on every project and exhibition. Full budgeting and reporting of exhibitions, which began last year, has been maintained.

Arrangements are now underway to lease the Museum Souvenir Shops. This should enable further economies in administration.

PERSONNEL AND OFFICE SERVICES

The Section continued its primary aim of providing a comprehensive range of personnel services to the Museum. The planned implementation of devolved Public Service Board Delegations was postponed owing to staff shortages at the Ministry for the Arts. As part of the devolutions process advice was received early in the year that a new computer system called PERSPAY would soon be introduced throughout the Public Service. This system has an on-line capacity which will contain all personnel records and prepare complex reports as required by management. It also has the potential of greatly increasing the efficiency of the Section. All information pertaining to Ministry Branches will be keyed into the system at Head Office prior to divesting files to the relevant Branch.

STORES AND TRANSPORT

The Section provides stores to the Museum, co-ordinates and maintains the vehicle fleet, handles the movement of goods and liaises with officers of the State Tender Board, Vicfleet and other relevant agencies.

A plan to relocate and re-organise the Stores and Transport Office and the Central Store was approved this year and will be implemented next financial year.

LIBRARY SERVICES

The Museum Library continued to provide a specialised information service for Museum staff, researchers, and other organisations.

The Library maintains collections of journals, books, rare books, archival materials (including photographs and motion pictures) and microforms. One of the major activities of the Library is the exchange programme. 500 copies of the **Memoirs** and **Occasional Papers** were exchanged during 1987-88.

A new staff structure for the Library was approved during the year:

Library Manager, Class LIB-2
Librarian, Class LIB-1
Library Technician, Class LT-2
Clerical Officer, Class CO-2

Two major acquisitions were the Astronomy Library, donated by Dr Bruce Poppleton, and the Antarctica Library, donated by Sir Thomas Ramsay.

During the year the Library began a programme of collecting materials relating to Museum of Victoria exhibitions. It was agreed also that the Museum Library would link up with the State Library of Victoria on-line computer cataloguing system, which will be operational next financial year.

SAFETY/SECURITY AND CLEANING SERVICES

This Section maintains the appearance of galleries and outside areas, assists members of the public to enjoy their visit to the Museum and provides security for the public, the collections and the building. The employment rate of females to males has not altered significantly during the year. However, the job description has changed to highlight the equal employment opportunity factor in an endeavour to encourage more applications from women.

In an attempt to alleviate the tediousness of duties undertaken and to reduce the incidence of sick leave, the following innovations were introduced:

- no more than two days of duty in succession within a specific gallery;
- when staff levels permitted roving patrols were undertaken;
- in areas where excessive humidity or high noise levels existed no more than four hours duty per day was undertaken by a member of staff in the gallery;
- where staffing levels permitted a system of regular reliefs was undertaken.

Internal staff training has been provided to Safety/Security staff in the areas of Area Warden, Fire Fighting, Emergency Evacuation Procedures and Building Familiarisation. Fifteen Safety/Security officers have attended workshops of two days duration in the field of Public Relations and Communication skills which were conducted under the auspices of the Ministry for the Arts. The general feedback from officers who have attended is that they have found this course both informative and beneficial to their employment. Further workshops are being planned.

OCCUPATIONAL HEALTH AND SAFETY COMMITTEE

The Occupational Health and Safety Committee operates under the **Occupational Health and Safety Act** and consists of elected OHS representatives and management representatives. The Committee meets every two months.

This year the Committee has achieved the following results:

- Emergency procedures have been completed and distributed to staff;
- Laboratory Safety Code has been completed and distributed to staff;
- Safety procedures for handling glass have been completed and distributed to staff;
- Accident reports have been noted and discussed at each meeting;
- A commitment by the Museum's Corporate Management Group has been made to install a First Aid Room.

The Museum also sends two representatives to the Ministry for the Arts Health Safety & Welfare Co-ordination Committee. The Museum has set an example to other Branches by holding regular OHS Committee meetings and taking positive action in the workplace.

THE BUILDINGS MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE

The Buildings Management Committee is established in accordance with the provisions of the **Museums Act** 1983 and has responsibility for the entire Museum/State Library Works Programme.

The members of the Committee for 1987-88 were:

Professor J.W. Warren, President, Council of the Museum of Victoria (Chairman)
Mr P.S. Parkin, Council of the Museum of Victoria;
Dr N. Curry, President, Library Council of Victoria;
Mrs J. La Scala, Nominee, Library Council of Victoria.

The Committee met on three occasions during the year to consider, approve and monitor progress of the overall Works Programme and placed particular emphasis on works related to occupational health and safety and those specified by the City of Melbourne and the Metropolitan Fire Brigade Notice as required to provide the appropriate level of fire protection and prevention within the building Complex.

The Committee is pleased to report that considerable progress was made on the medium term programme of works developed for the building complex during the year. The Works Programme consists of two sections, they are (i) 'Annual Provisions', i.e. works to maintain and improve the services, conditions and fabric of the building, and (ii) 'Project Provisions', i.e. individual projects with a specific allocation of funds to provide particular improvements. The Annual Provisions programme was satisfactorily completed and the allocation of funds fully expended.

Works Programme

The total allocation for Works and Services for the Museum/State Library Complex for 1987-88 was $1,740,000. The allocation was split $790,000 for Annual Provisions, which was fully expended; $76,000 for Project Provisions; and $194,000 for DSA expenses. As previously indicated, it was not possible to proceed with some of the major projects scheduled under the Projects Provisions programme and the expenditure generated therefore was $249,300.

Following is a brief summary of the main works undertaken during the year and the expenditure of funds.

Annual Provisions. Allocation $790,000 - Expenditure $840,216. To qualify for insurance indemnification for the international touring exhibition **First Impressions** by the Federal Government it was necessary to install special security measures as specified by the Australian Protective Service. As the Annual Provisions Programme was fully committed when these requirements became known, special permission was sought and gained to transfer $54,000 from the Project Provisions Programme to fund the works.

Urgent and Essential Works (Departmental Allocation). Allocation: $200,000 - Expenditure $199,967. Extensive minor electrical, plumbing, carpentry, mechanical and other building maintenance works were completed to ensure that the building complex was maintained at a safe and operative level. This is a departmental allocation and arrangements for the works are managed directly by the Building and Property Section.

Project Provisions. Allocation: $756,000 - Expenditure: $249,259. A total of $54,000 was transferred from this allocation to Annual Provisions late in the financial year to enable security works to be completed in the McCoy Hall.

Dovers Building. Allocation: $143,000 - Expenditure: Nil. Works to provide a structural strengthening of the different floors in the building together with an upgrade of the lifts to Department of Labour requirements deferred pending clarification of redevelopment proposals for the Museum and State Library. However, a contract for the work was let at the end of the year and the work will be completed in 1988-89.

Modifications for Fire Safety. Allocation: $613,000 - Expenditure: $249,529. Stage 2 of the installation of new fire doors within the complex was substantially completed and works on the installation of emergency exit signs and emergency lighting were completed.

Work on Stage 3 of the installation of new fire doors commenced, with completion scheduled for 1988-89. A contract was also let for the installation of an emergency intercommunication system throughout the building complex. The system is to include an emergency alarm, public address and warden emergency telephone systems.

Works planned to provide emergency exit stairs from the State Library Reading Room Annuli estimated to cost $270,000 did not proceed and are now being held pending clarification of redevelopment proposals for the Museum and the State Library.

Security Works undertaken included the installation of a new security lock system throughout the building complex which provides a more secure lock system than the previous 'Yale' type system and the capacity for greater control over the issue and management of keys, together with the installation of the security measures in the McCoy Hall for the **First Impressions** exhibition as previously indicated.

Refurbishment Works. Allocation: $226,500 - Expenditure: $248,057. The main work undertaken was completion of the major refurbishment of the Preparation Workshops. The area previously provided antiquated working conditions which had been highlighted by the VPSA as totally inadequate for one of the most specialised areas within the Museum. Also completed was the replacement of worn and dangerous carpet in the State Library's Reference and Information Centre, one of the most highly trafficked areas in the building complex.

Minor Works. Allocation: $116,200 - Expenditure: $128,413. A considerable number of smaller projects were completed under this allocation. They included:

- installation of new partitioning in the curatorial work/collection areas at the Abbotsford Annex to upgrade air handling arrangement;
- provision of wheelchair access to the first floor areas in the eastern section of the building;
- repainting of the Swanston Street and Russell Street entrance foyers and the general upgrading of several exhibition galleries;
- modifications to the heating equipment in the LaTrobe Library to provide more satisfactory arrangements for humidity control for the air conditioning equipment on the third floor, Manuscripts and Picture Collection, of the LaTrobe Library and replacement of undersized heating mains in Queens Hall.

A range of office furniture and equipment was acquired under this allocation together with the arrangement of a number of telephone modifications to accommodate new and relocated staff within the complex.

Electrical Works & Roof Repairs. Allocation: $13,000 - Expenditure: $9,757. This expenditure was required to meet carried forward commitments from works involved in replacing the main electrical switchboard last year and in roof repairs at the Abbotsford Annex.

Storage Cabinets and Shelving. Allocation: $30,400 - Expenditure: $20,304. Requests for the supply of cabinets and shelving to a value in excess of the allocation were lodged with the Supply Branch, Ministry of Housing and Construction. Unfortunately, Supply Branch were unable to arrange supply of sufficient equipment to effect total expenditure of the allocation.

Thermal Alarms. Allocation: $40,700 - Expenditure: $55,000. The main work undertaken was the installation of a computer monitor station in the security control centre for monitoring the thermal and smoke detection system throughout the building complex and the connection of the system's alarm panels (located at the three main entrances to the building) back to the computer monitor station.

Safety and Security Works. Allocation: $113,100 - Expenditure: $128,736. The existing air handling equipment in the Natural History Section's curatorial work/collection storage areas at the Abbotsford Annex was substantially upgraded to cope with the extraction of air fouled with chemicals in use in the collection storage process and to provide an acceptable quality of air for staff working in these areas. Work was completed also on improving the ventilation system in the State Library's North West Wing.

Substantial progress has been made on works specified in the MCC-MFB Notice to provide adequate fire protection and prevention within the building. Stages 1 and 2 of the new fire door installation programme have been substantially completed. Stage 3 was commenced during the year and is expected to be completed next year. The programme of installation of emergency exit signs and emergency lighting has also been completed and a contract was let for the installation of an emergency intercommunication system, which is also to be completed next financial year. This system includes an emergency alarm system, a public address system, and a fire warden emergency telephone system located throughout the complex.

The Occupational Health and Safety Committee of the Museum and the State Library continued to investigate and monitor progress on health and safety issues throughout the building. The work of the Committees included the production and issue to all staff of **Interim Emergency Evacuation Procedures**. A number of training courses have also been conducted for Area Wardens and it is anticipated that practice evacuation drills will be conducted early next financial year.

Work on the Swanston Street facade stonework continued during the year. The water mist cleaning process was completed to allow a proper investigation to be made of the extent of restoration work required. This also was completed and a programme of restoration work has now been established and will be completed in 1988-89.

APPENDIXES

APPENDIX 1

COUNCIL OF THE MUSEUM OF VICTORIA

PRESIDENT
Professor James Wolfe Warren, MA, PhD

DEPUTY PRESIDENT
Mr Peter Stuart Parkin, BEE

TREASURER
Mr Ian Sinclair, FAC

MEMBERS
Mrs Margaret Cameron
Mr Jack Ellis
Mr Peter Murphy Harvie
Mrs Valmae June Heap
Dr Marilyn Lake, MA, PhD
Mrs Sarah June Myer
Mrs Caroline Searby
Mr Gary Woodard

EXECUTIVE OFFICER
Mr Robert Edwards

SECRETARY
Mrs Anne Watson

APPENDIX 2

Staff

Directorate

DIRECTOR
Robert Edwards

SECRETARY
Anne Watson

NATURAL HISTORY DIVISION

HEAD OF DIVISION: James H. Bowler MSc, PhD

TECHNICAL OFFICER: P.D. Johnstone
SECRETARY: Lyn Anderson
TYPIST: Lisa Giuliani

GEOLOGY

HEAD OF GEOLOGY: Thomas Darragh MSc, PhD, DipEd

Department of Mineralogy and Petrology

CURATOR: Bill Birch, BSc(Hons), PhD
TECHNICAL OFFICER: Dermot Henry

Department of Invertebrate Palaeontology

CURATOR: Vacant
ASSISTANT CURATOR: David Holloway BSc (Hons) PhD
TECHNICAL ASSISTANT: Penny Clark

Department of Vertebrate Palaeontology and Palaeobotany

CURATOR: Tom Rich AB, MA, PhD
TECHNICAL ASSISTANT: Elizabeth Thompson

ZOOLOGY

Invertebrate Zoology

Department of Invertebrate Zoology

CURATOR: Chung Cheng Lu, MSc PhD
ASSISTANT CURATOR: Suzanne Boyd BSc
TECHNICAL OFFICER: Rhyllis Plant

Department of Crustacea

CURATOR: Gary Poore BSc(Hons) PhD
TECHNICAL OFFICER: Robin Wilson, BSc (Hons)

Department of Entomology

CURATOR: Arturs Neboiss, MSc, PhD, FRES
ASSISTANT CURATOR: Ken Walker BAgrSc, MSc
TECHNICAL OFFICER: Catriona McPhee BAgrSc, AssDipOpera and MusicTh

Department of Biological Survey

SURVEY OFFICER: Alan Yen BSc(Hons)PhD
TECHNICAL OFFICER: Richard Marchant BSc(Hons) PhD

Australian Watermites Project

Mark Harvey BSc, PhD

Thomson River Post-construction Project

Richard Marchant BSc(Hons), PhD
Graham Milledge BSc(Hons),

Acheron River Project

Tim Doeg BSc(Hons), PhD
Graham Milledge BSc(Hons),

Flora and Fauna Guarantee Project

Patrick Vaughan BSc(Hons)

Giant Gippsland Earthworm Project

Beverley Van Praagh BSc(Hons), (PhD student)

Vertebrate Zoology

Department of Ichthyology

CURATOR: Martin Gomon, MSc, PhD
TECHNICAL OFFICER: Mark Norman, BSc(Hons), DipEd

Department of Herpetology

OFFICER IN CHARGE: John Coventry

Department of Ornithology

CURATOR: Leslie Christidis BSc(Hons), PhD
TECHNICAL ASSISTANT: Belinda Gillies, BA, DipEd

Department of Mammalogy

CURATOR: Joan Dixon BSc(Hons)
TECHNICAL OFFICER: Linda Huxley, BSc

SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY DIVISION

HEAD OF DIVISION: Boyce Pizzey BA, MBA

SENIOR CURATOR: Martin Hallett MAgSci, DipEd
MANAGER SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY PROGRAMMES: Robin Hirst BSc(Hons), PhD, DipEd
CURATOR OF ARMS: Ray Fielding

CURATOR OF ELECTRONICS, COMMUNICATIONS AND MEDICINE: Geoffrey Holden DipChem
CURATOR OF ENGINEERING AND TRANSPORT: William Sidebottom BSc
CURATOR OF NUMISMATICS: John Sharples MA

CURATOR OF PHOTOGRAPHY: Euan McGillivray DipArt and Design (Photog)
REGISTRAR: Ruth Leveson Assoc. Dip.Lib.(RMIT), Grad.Dip.Mus.Stud.
RESEARCH SCIENTIST: Hayden Downing MAgrSc, BEd, BA, PhD
TECHNICAL ASSISTANT: Caroline Carter BA(Hons) DipMuseumStud
ADMINISTRATION: Patricia Bone, Julie Witzand
ASSISTANTS, ASTRONOMY: Zelko Karlovic, Richard Allen

PUBLIC PROGRAMMES DIVISION

HEAD OF DIVISION: John Chessells, BA (Deputy Director of Public Programmes)

SECRETARY: Ms. Patty Kalogeropoulos, CertBusStudies (Secretarial)

PUBLIC RELATIONS MANAGER: Margaret Barca

MANAGER, MUSEUM RESOURCE SERVICE: Eric McClellan, BSc(Hons), PhD(Melb), DipEd

Design Department

SENIOR DESIGNER: Mark Patullo, DipArt(Graphic Design)
DESIGNERS: Zoran Lazarevic, DipIndDes; Sue Grieve, DipArt (Graphic Design); Sandra Lucey, DipArt (Graphic Design); Lawrie Mitchell, DipIndDes; Sue Palmer, BA(Art & Design); Sue Schipano, Designer

Photography Department

MANAGER: Frank Coffa, DipArt(Photo Illus), BA
PHOTOGRAPHERS: Rodney Start, BA(Photography); Jon Augier Cert of Photographic Ass/Technician, Shane Le Page, Peter Mappin, Vanessa Martin, Rhys Jones

Preparators Department

SENIOR PREPARATOR: Michael Traynor
PREPARATORS: Kevin Kelly; Peter Swinkels, Antonia Love DipArt(Visual Art); Catherine Thorpe BA; Chris Rowley; Dean Smith

Construction Workshop

CARPENTERS: Bill Bassett; Michael Neighbour; Tony Di Berardino; Ron Buzza
PAINTER: Con Cornelissen

Conservation Section

SENIOR CONSERVATOR: Daniel Tworek, MSc
CONSERVATORS: Bill Snoek, BA(Hons); Margaret Perkins, BAgr, DipMusStud

Technical Workshop

SUPERVISOR: Dal Babare
TECHNICIANS: Laurie Carter, Cert of Electronics; Jim Cozens, AssDip of Applied Science

Education Service

SENIOR EDUCATION OFFICER: Ms. Rosemary Taylor, BA BEd TPTC
EDUCATION OFFICER: Helen Edmonds, BA DIPTeach (Primary) MEnvironStud; Rosemary O'Shea, BA, DipEd; Phillip Spencer, BSc, DipEd; Elaine Shields, BA DipEd; Patrick Lyons, DipTeach(Primary); Sally Howard, CertEd, BEd; Eva Harrison, DipTeach (Primary); Genevieve Fahey, BSc(Hons), DipEd; Dave Demant, BSc(Hons) PGradCertofEd; Lynette Beasley, BA TPTC; Kerrie Aulsebrook, DipEd(Primary); Peggy Cole, BSc DipEd; Phillip Bailey, BA DipEd; Carolyn Meehan, BEd(Catholic Ed) DipTeach(Primary); Zelko Karlovic (Part-time) BSc DipEd; Prue Keulemans (Part-time) BA(Hons) DipEd; Helen Edwards (Part-time) DipTeach(Primary) BA MSc (En); Elaine McCarthy, Clerical Assistant; Valerie McCormack, Clerical Assistant;

Children's Museum

DIRECTOR: Rachel Faggetter, BA DipEd
PROGRAMMES CO-ORDINATOR: Ruth Povall, BA DipEd
CO-ORDINATOR OF DISCOVERY ROOM: Dianne Beevers, DipArt(Ed)
VOLUNTEER CO-ORDINATOR: Lauris Jephcott (part-time)
VOLUNTEER SUPERVISOR: Trish Brawn, (casual) DipEd

RESEARCH ASSISTANT/VOLUNTEER: Gwen Day, BA(Psychol); Solo Seal, Royal Academy of Dancing, Intermediate; Geraldine Nicholas, BSc DipEd - to January 1987
ADMINISTRATIVE ASSISTANT: Jenni Dale, Colleen Wendt (part-time)

Design Consultants

Grant and Mary Featherston
TRAVELLING EXHIBITION RESEARCH ASSISTANT: Karen Gough, BSc

Commercial Operations

Gair Amina-Cone, Manager, Commercial Operations BA DipEd; Sylvia Clements, Swanston Street Shop Assistant; Sylvia Murray, Swanston Street Shop Assistant; Katherine Ryan, Russell Street Shop Assistant; Vanessa Martin, Ticket Seller for Exhibitions, Russell Street Shop Assistant and Photography Assistant

Community Services

Marje Minchin, Co-ordinator of Volunteers BA(Hons); Penny Morison, Co-ordinator of Outreach Programme BSc; Lorraine Langmuir, Secretary/Administrative Officer; Colleen Wendt, Friends Co-ordinator

HUMAN STUDIES DIVISION

HEAD OF DIVISION Andrew Reeves BA(Hons), MA
ADMINISTRATION: Tracey Henst
COLLECTIONS MANAGEMENT REGISTRAR: Julia Findlay BA

Aboriginal Studies

CURATORS: Gaye Sculthorpe BA, GradDipMusStudies; Donald Thomson Collection: Gael Ramsay MA(Hons)

Oceanic Studies

CURATOR: Ron Vanderwal MA DipMuseology PhD

History

CURATORS: Elizabeth Willis MA DipLib; Suzanne Hunt BA(Hons) GradDipMusStudies; Nellie Zola BA(Hons) DipEd GradDipMusStudies
RESEARCH OFFICER: Liza Dale BA(Hons)

Victorian Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Unit

CO-ORDINATOR: John Atkinson
ABORIGINAL LIAISON OFFICERS: Lori Richardson; Sandra Smith BA

Victorian Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Trust

EXHIBITION CURATOR: Chris Hogarth BA GradDipMatCult
RESEARCH OFFICER: Melanie Raberts BA
TRAINEE IN ABORIGINAL CULTURAL HERITAGE AND COLLECTIONS MANAGEMENT: Jim Berg

MANAGEMENT SERVICES DIVISION

HEAD OF DIVISION: John Zolis, BJuris
SECRETARY: Sally Scott

Personnel

PERSONNEL MANAGER: Rodney Dale
ASSISTANT PERSONNEL MANAGER: Carl Lee BA
LEAVE CLERK: Eileen Kernohan, Kerrie Lovell
PERSONNEL CLERK: Sian Bonney
TYPISTS: Irene Skaras, Clara Rayment
SWITCHBOARD OPERATOR: Margaret Shanahan
REGISTRY OFFICER: Ron Brook

Building & Property

MANAGER: Vic Finlay MIE Aust
ASSISTANT MANAGER: Glenn Howard BA
STORES & TRANSPORT OFFICER: Barry McKay
STOREMEN: Mark Marchesi, Steven Deer

Finance & Accounts

FINANCE MANAGER: David Gillard
FINANCIAL CONTROLLER: Bernard Barnewall
AUDIT & SPECIAL PROJECTS: Alan Brydon
ACCOUNTS SUPERVISOR: Kevin Feeney, Linda Marks
ACCOUNTS OFFICERS: Ian Gartlan, Annie Baker, Deborah Gombarovic
REVENUE OFFICER: Michael Milovitch

Library Services

MANAGER: Julieanne New BA ALAA
LIBRARIANS: Frank Job BA, DipLib, Grace Anderson BEc, PDipLib
CLERICAL OFFICER: Lilli Galli

Safety/Security

SUPERVISOR: Jack King (Acting)
ASSISTANT SUPERVISOR: Russell Marshall (Acting)
SAFETY/SECURITY OFFICERS: Mario Abela, John Allen, Arthur Ashton, Less Attard, John Beeston, Charles Bonavia, Anthony Bonica, Les Brian, Alan Bunston, Frank Burton, Carol Clark, Don Clark, Alan Cotter, Ron Crosby, Joe Cutajar, Ken Dewhurst, Paul Ebert, Bill Grech, Rodney Grey, Kim Haines, Greg Hodgkinson, Ted Joselin, Peter Kilduff, Michael Knight, Jim Longworth, Neil McGain, John McGuire, Greg McKenzie, Ted Mapleback, Robyn Moore, Paul Murchison, John O'Halloran, Claude Parrini, Lawrence Pitt, Peter Rayment, Rudolf Rebeiro, Michael Redmond (Snr), Michael Redmond (Jnr.), Simon Sammut, Daniel Sibincic, Sue Spina, John Stevens, Jack Van Der Beek, Jeff Van Der Wolf, Ray Vella, Anton Wedmidski, Chris Zikos.
CLEANERS: Nick Angeletos, Carmen Cassar, Connie Cilia, Jeff Cilia, Nunzia DeGrande, Georgia Dounis, Irene File, Joanne Gianacopoulos, David Harley, Kon Hatzidakis, Harry Hiotellis, Anna Illias, Joanna Kambouris, Maria Kambouris, Chrisoula Markopoulos, Maria Peluso, Katica Radman, Kevin Shannon, Nick Stassinopoulos, Maria Tapia, Isabella Tomaino, Lina Tsolakis, Connie Ventrice.

APPENDIX 3

Honorary Positions and Volunteers

HONORARY POSITIONS

Human Studies:

Alistair Campbell MD, Doug Ellicott, John Mulvaney PhD, Robert Rowlands, Geoff Walker BA, Noel Wallace, Judith Wiseman BA

VOLUNTEER PERSONNEL

The following people have given much time throughout the year in assisting staff in regular Departmental work. They have contributed so much towards extending museum work generally. The Museum gratefully acknowledges their assistance.

NATURAL HISTORY: L. Jankovic, K. Cox, B. French, E. McLulloch, R. Nettleton, R. O'Brien, W. Bock, F. Holmes, E. Holmes, J. Reeder, B. Argo, C. Handreck, C. Hurley, F. Kearney, D. Phillips, C. Sgro, F. Stewart, F. Crandall, J. Beardsley, M. Cirvydas, K. Ebert, R. Kwong, J. Greaves, T. Gunn, M. Day, J. Lamond, L. Haupt, J. Leach, F. Robinson, R. Poole, E. Bannister, I. Brailey, G. Braziotis, C. de Groot, L. Kool, B. Lush, C. Macrae, M. Rowley, N. van Klaveren

PUBLIC PROGRAMMES: M. Adamson, J. Aguan, E. Aicken, P. Baitz, P. Baker, S. Bartoszewitz, D. Beavis, J. Beardsley, D. Belingham, T. Bruchell, P. Calvert, C. Cawthan, M. Chan, G. Chomiak, P. Clements, E. Cobb, M. Coillett, M. Craig, F. Crandall, V. Crohn, G. Dawson, S. Dawson, M. Dean, J. Degabriel, A. Dufty, J. Everett, A. Fairweather, B. French, P. Ford, A. Griffiths, M. Gonshor, K. Gould, C. Grima, P. Gruar, N. Gruar, C. Hall, J. Hall, J. Hart, K. Hartin, P. Heazlewood, S. Jackson, R. Jones, S. Konenko, L. Langtree, J. Malmgren, R. Marchionda, J. Marks, L. Mumford, A. McClagish, T. McDonald, N. McGillivray, M. McKillop, R. Orr, J. Paddle, N. Paddle, R. Parrett, M. Paul, E. Pearson, S. Pang, J. Ramadan, P. Rennison, N. Roberts, J. Ross, R. Russell, L. Russell-Cook, E. Savage, M. Schaffer, A. Sherwood, L. Smith, P. Soccio, J. Snyder, B. Splatt, P. Storey, W. Steinke, F. Steuart, B. Tranter, P. Urban, E. Usher, S. Vannetti, S. Vetro, D. Vorich, H. Walsh, L. Whiting, N. Whitewell, A. Wilson, P. Wilson.

SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY: A. Brothers, A. Fairweather, S. Goldsworthy, V. Routley, L. Sprunt, W. Vears, B. Adcock, K. Beard, V. Celna, B. Clark, A. Coombs, I. Downes, F. Farr, L. Foster, K. Fowler, E. Gainsford, K. Griffin, A. Guarino, N. Hargrave, J. Izzo, R. Lawrence, D. Martin, S. Pattie, N. Plever, P. Pottage, B. Racine, J. Reeves, L. Stevens, I. Sullivan, J. Trainor, J. White.

HUMAN STUDIES: P. Broughton, R. Burns, J. Clarke, J. Edwards, M. Elden, M. Gordon-Clark, F. Granville, S. Hunt, L. Kiers, C. Klug, H. Marfurt, W. Moore, G. Robb, M. Thomson, R. Vandersluys, D. Watson, J. Wiseman.

APPENDIX 4

Publications by Staff

Natural History

ARCHER, M., TEDFORD, R.H. AND RICH, T.H. 1987. The Pilkipildridae, a new family and four new species of petauroid possums (Marsupialia: Phalangerida) from the Australian Miocene, **in**: Archer, M. (ed.) **Possums and Oppossums: Studies in Evolution.** Sydney, pp. 607-627.

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BIRCH, W.D. and Pring, A. 1987. A note on synchysite-(Ce) from Broken Hill, New South Wales. **Australian Mineralogist** 2(2), pp. 13-15.

BIRCH, W.D. 1988. Cowlesite from Flinders and Jindivick, Victoria. **Australian Mineralogist 3(1), pp. 9-11.**

BIRCH, W.D., Burke, E.A.J., Wall, V.J. and Etheridge, M.A. 1988. Ecandrewsite, the zinc analogue of ilmenite from Little Broken Hill, New South Wales, Australia, and the San Valentin Mine, Sierra de Cartegena Spain. **Mineralogical Magazine** 52, pp. 237-240.

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CHRISTIDIS, L. 1987. Chromosomal evolution within the family Estrildidae (Aves). III. The Estrildidae. **Genetica** 72, pp. 93-100.

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Darragh, T.A. 1987. Columbariinae (Gastropoda: Turbinellidae) from Queensland, Australia. **Proc. R. Soc. Vict.** 99(4), pp. 127-134.

DIXON, J.M. 1988. Historical Aspects of Collection Conservation in: **Mammal Collection Management** ed. Genoways, H.H.; Jones, C., Rossolino, O. Texas Tech. Univ. Press, pp. 157-72.

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APPENDIX 5

AUDITOR GENERAL'S REPORT

AUDITOR-GENERAL'S REPORT

The accompanying financial statements comprising a balance sheet, statement of income and expenditure, statement of sources and applications of funds and notes to the financial statements of the Council of the Museum of Victoria for the year ended 30 June 1988, prepared in a format approved by the Treasurer, have been audited as required by the Museums Act 1983 and in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards.

The Council has neither quantified nor valued the land, buildings and certain other real and personal fixed assets including the Collections of the Museum, vested in the Council. Since the Council accepts substantially all the risks and benefits incidental to ownership of these assets, it is my opinion that all assets vested in the Council should have been valued and recorded as assets in the financial statements.

In my opinion, due to the significance of the matter referred to above, the financial statements do not present fairly the state of the affairs of the Council of the Museum of Victoria as at 30 June 1988 or the results of its operations for the year ended on that date in accordance with Australian Accounting Standards.

MELBOURNE C.A. BARAGWANATH
09/02/1989 Auditor-General

COUNCIL OF THE MUSEUM OF VICTORIA

In our opinion, the accompanying financial statements comprising a balance sheet, statement of income and expenditure and statement of sources and applications of funds are in accordance with the requirements of Section 30 of the Museums Act 1983 and present fairly the financial transactions during the 1987/88 financial year and the financial position as at 30 June 1988 of the Museum of Victoria.

At the date of this certificate, the Council is not aware of any circumstances which would render any particulars included in the statements to be misleading or inaccurate.

(RAY MARGINSON) CHAIRMAN 6/2/1989

(IAN SINCLAIR) TREASURER 3/2/1989

COUNCIL OF THE MUSEUM OF VICTORIA
BALANCE SHEET AS AT 30 JUNE, 1988

	NOTES	1987/88 $	$	1986/87 $
CURRENT ASSETS —				
Cash at Bank			123,869	471,037
Cash on Hand			3,366	3,972
Debtors	11		70,927	20,237
Stock of Goods for Resale	1(e)			
— Museum Shop		169,603		140,798
— Other		4,119	173,722	10,243
			371,884	646,287
INVESTMENTS (AT COST)	2		1,051,137	781,827
NON-CURRENT ASSETS	1			
Motor vehicles	8	15,088		20,164
Shop Assets	8	119,200		144,089
Furniture and Equipment	8	164,927		100,897
Collections	9	296,725	595,940	250,507
TOTAL ASSETS			2,018,961	1,943,771
CURRENT LIABILITIES — Creditors			122,084	135,234
NON-CURRENT LIABILITIES				
Security Deposit on Hand	7 (a) 1		5,000	-
Accumulated Funds	10		1,891,877	1,808,537
TOTAL EQUITY AND LIABILITIES			2,018,961	1,943,771

This Statement should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes.

COUNCIL OF THE MUSEUM OF VICTORIA
STATEMENT OF INCOME AND EXPENDITURE FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 1988

INCOME	NOTES	1987/88 $	1986/87 $
Grants	6	1,432,741	1,018,809
Fees and Charges		411,161	329,246
Interest	5	158,883	133,048
Operating Profit from Commercial Operations	7	76,665	24,907
Other Sales		57,298	71,061
Donations	4	55,959	49,856
Rent	7(a)1	45,800	-
Miscellaneous		15,800	13,686
TOTAL INCOME	1(f)	2,254,307	1,640,613

EXPENDITURE

Expenditure	3	2,170,967	1,485,921
Surplus (Deficit) for year	12	83,340	154,692
Balance 1 July 1987		1,808,537	1,653,845
Accumulated Surplus 30 June 1988	10	1,891,877	1,808,537

This Statement should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes.

COUNCIL OF THE MUSEUM OF VICTORIA STATEMENT OF SOURCES AND APPLICATIONS OF FUNDS FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 1988

	NOTES	1987/88 $	$	1986/87 $
SOURCES OF FUNDS				
Funds from Operations				
Inflow of funds from Operations	12	2,254,307		1,640,613
Less outflows of funds from Operations		2,090,113		1,426,035
			164,194	214,578
Reduction in Assets				
Current Assets				
Cash at Bank		347,168		-
Cash on Hand		606		-
Debtors		-		11,695
			347,774	
Proceeds from Sale of Investments			-	361,127
Increase in Liabilities				
Current Liabilities				
Creditors			-	31,101
Security Deposit			5,000	-
			516,968	618,501
APPLICATIONS OF FUNDS				
Increase in Assets				
Current Assets				
Cash on Hand		-		1,110
Cash at Bank		-		429,472
Investments		269,310		-
Debtors	11	55,880		-
Stocks		22,681		33,031
			347,871	
Non Current Assets				
Shop	8	480		16,706
Furniture & Equip.	8	109,249		29,116
Collections	9	46,218		109,066
			155,947	

Reduction in Liabilities		
Current Liabilities		
Creditors	13,150	-
	516,968	618,501

This Statement should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes.

COUNCIL OF THE MUSEUM OF VICTORIA
NOTES TO AND FORMING PART OF THE ACCOUNTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE, 1988

1. ACCOUNTING POLICIES

(a) These accounts have been prepared in accordance with S30 of the MUSEUMS ACT 1983.

(b) These accounts have been prepared under the historical cost convention and have not been adjusted to take account of the current cost of specific assets or their impact on the operating results. The accounts for income and expenditure are on an accrual and going concern basis.

(c) Until 30 June, 1984 funds used for the purchases of non-current assets were recorded as expenditure in the year's accounts. The only assets shown in the Balance Sheet were those which were in the form of, or which would or could be converted into, cash or its equivalent, viz. investments, debtors, stocks on hand, and those used in the Museum Shop operations. As from 1 July 1984, assets purchased by the Council have been capitalised in the Balance Sheet.

(d) Depreciation is charged on non-current assets (except Collections) at rates assessed to match the cost of these assets against their estimated economical lives. Depreciation is calculated on the straight line method.

(e) Stocks have been valued at the lower of cost or net realisable value.

(f) Grants from Government and other sources are brought to account as income as received. Expenditure from such Grants are included as expenses when incurred.

(g) Until 30 June 1987 interest was brought to account only as it was received. As from 1987/88 accrued interest has been brought to account (see Note 5).

2. INVESTMENTS

Investments are held for the purpose of gaining income and are not normally sold before maturity.

They are recorded in the accounts at cost.

Investments on hand as at 30 June, 1988 were:

	1987/88	1986/87
	$	$
Commonwealth Government Securities	206,700	206,700
Semi Government Securities	240,000	240,000
Negotiable Certificates of Deposit, Interest bearing Deposits, and other Money Market Securities	587,437	318,127
Other Securities	17,000	17,000
	1,051,137	781,827

3. EXPENDITURE (See Note 3a)

	1987/88	1986/87
	$	$
Salaries and Wages	520,251	453,304
WorkCare Levy	5,437	4,737
Travelling & Subsistence	78,990	59,715
Consultants	33,999	291,208

Display Materials	98,230	92,530
Other Materials	17,708	4,005
Contract Display for Exhibitions & Displays	693,455	125,591
Other Contractors	56,657	3,586
Cost of Goods for Resale	34,097	44,192
Advertising & Publicity	29,187	36,082
Books and Publications	2,860	3,981
EDP Expenses	3,891	4,041
Equipment Hire	5,899	-
Equipment Maintenance	6,260	4,540
Freight	30,362	6,477
Functions and Hospitality	75,488	67,646
Grants	42,989	86,381
Insurance	3,551	178
Office Requisites Printing & Stationery	114,071	54,875
Photographic Supplies & Services	39,308	50,718
Postage & Telephone	9,183	5,156
Rent	6,910	-
Audit Fees	36,620	18,570
Bad Debts	3,223	571
Depreciation	50,293	33,474
Profit Sharing Payments	151,285	21,589
Miscellaneous	20,763	12,774
	2,170, 967	1,485,921

3(a) SERVICES PROVIDED BY THE MINISTRY FOR THE ARTS

In addition to the expenditure incurred by the Council of the Museum of Victoria an amount of $8,630,228 (1986/87 $10,470, 742) was expended from Funds appropriated to the Ministry for the Arts. Major components of this expenditure included:

	1987/88	1986/87
	$	$
Salaries and related costs	5,008,523	5,020,049
Operating expenses	1,015,936	1,000,667
Other Recurrent Expenses	6,582	44,940
Works and Services	2,599,187	4,405,086
	8,630,228	10,470,742

4. DONATIONS

	1987/88	1986/87
	$	$
Amounts of $5,000 and Over:-		
R.B. & P.F. Lewis	5,000	
Bendigo Building Society	9,000	
Elizabeth Murdoch Trust	5,000	
Bendigo Building Society	9,000	
Perpetual Executors Trustees	5,000	
The Sydney Myer Trust Fund	10,000	
	43,000	35,000
Various smaller donations and collections from Donation Boxes	12,959	14,856
	55,959	49,856

5. INTEREST

(a) SOURCES

	$	$
Commonwealth Government Securities	31,894	26,420
Semi Government Securities	28,238	23,325
Negotiable Certificates of Deposit, Interest bearing Deposits and other Money Market Securities	96,313	81,050
Other Securities	2,438	2,253
	158,883	133,048

(b) ACCRUAL

The 1986/87 and 1987/88 interest received are not directly comparable due to including accrued interest for the first time on 30 June 1988. (The one off adjustment included in 1987/88 is $27,265).

6. GRANTS

(a) SOURCES

	1987/88 $	1986/87 $
State Grants	167,262	358,179
Commonwealth Grants	103,470	116,645
Other Grants	1,162,009	543,985
	1,432,741	1,018,809

(b) The grants indicated in Section 6(a) above totalling $1,432,741 were of an operating nature.

7. (a) COMMERCIAL OPERATIONS

Commercial Operations consists of:

1) A Coffee and Take-away food outlet located near the Swanston Street entrance. This was operated by the Museum until 30 August 1987. It was leased to a caterer for an annual rental based on turnover. A security deposit is held by the Council to ensure compliance with lease conditions.
2) Two Book and Souvenir outlets located near the Swanston and Russell Street entrances.
3) Photographic Services.

The following statement includes all commercial operations —

(b) COMMERCIAL OPERATIONS — STATEMENT OF INCOME AND EXPENDITURE

	$	1987/88 $	1986/87 $
Income			
Sales		633,363	897,651
Less Cost of Sales			
Opening Stock	140,798		96,799
Purchases	372,180		545,445
	512,978		642,244
Less Closing Stock	169,603		140,798
		343,375	501,446
Gross Profit		289,988	396,205

Expenditure			
Salaries & Wages	158,288		285,557
WorkCare	1,654		3,091
Travelling	1,498		1,497
Advertising & Publicity	3,059		3,042
Cash Collection	10,799		9,179
Cleaning	91		1,056
Consultants	-		8,739
Equipment Hire	1,314		1,200
Equipment Maintenance	1,728		7,426
Finance Charges	1,632		1,233
Freight	713		552
Office Requisites Printing and Stationery	1,630		3,371
Packaging	916		15,566
Postage	1,250		1,421
Bad Debts	2,556		3,296
Depreciation	25,369		22,543
Miscellaneous	826		2,529
TOTAL EXPENDITURE		213,323	371,298
NET PROFIT (LOSS) ON OPERATIONS		76,665	24,907

(c) COMMERCIAL OPERATIONS — EVENTS AFTER BALANCE DATE

As at balance date the Council of the Museum of Victoria had decided to lease the Book and Souvenir outlets. Tendering procedures were in progress.

8. NON CURRENT ASSETS

		1987/88	1986/87
	$	$	$
Motor Vehicles			
Motor Vehicle	25,377		25,377
LESS accumulated depreciation	10,289	15,088	5,213
		15,088	20,164
Shop Assets			
Improvements	68,079		68,079
LESS accumulated depreciation	19,096	48,983	15,693
Plant and Equipment	62,135		61,655
LESS accumulated depreciation	39,841	22,294	27,415
Motor Vehicle	8,391		8,391
LESS accumulated depreciation	3,550	4,841	1,871
Furniture and Fittings	78,613		78,613
LESS accumulated depreciation	35,531	43,082	27,670
		119,200	144,089

Furniture and Equipment			
Equipment	146,035		96,759
LESS accumulated depreciation	61,048	84,987	36,718
EDP Equipment	84,685		59,231
LESS accumulated depreciation	35,760	48,925	20,623
Furniture and Fittings	37,910		3,391
LESS accumulated depreciation	6,895	31,015	1,143
		164,927	100,897

NOTE 9 COLLECTIONS

The Collections included in the balance sheet $296,725 (1986/87 $250,507) consist of only a very small part of the actual collections of the Museum.

The Collections of the Museum have been acquired over a long period by many means (including discovery, donation, manufacture, purchase) and no monetary value has ever been assigned to them. The Collections included in the balance sheet consist of only those purchased by the Council from Council Funds (i.e. not including State Budget Funds) and only of these since 1 July 1984.

The Collections which are included are valued at cost.

NOTE 10 ACCUMULATED FUNDS

	1987/88	1986/87
	$	$
Trust Funds	641,071	552,064
Externally Funded Special Projects	556,340	526,209
General Funds	694,466	730,264
	1,891,877	1,808,537

"Trust Funds" consist of those funds which may be used by the Council of the Museum for Museum purposes as defined by the relevant Trust deed or will.

"Externally Funded Special Projects" consist of unexpended Government and Other Grants tied to a specific purpose.

"General Funds" consist of all Council Funds not included in the other two categories.

NOTE 11 DEBTORS

	1987/88	1986/87
	$	$
Debtors	79,984	24,104
LESS Provision for Doubtful Debts	9,057	3,867
	70,927	20,237

NOTE 12 FUNDS FROM OPERATIONS

Reconciliation of Funds from operations with surplus is as follows:

		1987/88	1986/87
		$	$
Funds from operations		164,194	214,578
LESS Depreciation	75,664		56,019
Doubtful Debts	5,190		3,867
		80,854	
		83,340	154,692